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1 Preliminary Notes

1.1 Purpose, scope, and use

1.1.1 Purpose

The primary purposes of the FIAF Manual are to suggest recommendations for the description and identification of moving images (with an emphasis on archival moving images), and to define the elements of description to facilitate the exchange of information.

1.1.2 Scope

The manual is designed for use by institutions with moving image collections and cataloguers of moving images as a guide in the preparation of cataloguing records or descriptive metadata. The recommendations apply to generalised film and television collections, and may require elaboration in more specialised institutions whose holdings are exclusively of a single format or type, e.g., commercials, newsfilm, television, unedited footage, etc. For example, those with television collections should additionally consider more specific standards such as EBUcore or PBcore,

Moving images include a range of materials upon which sequences of visual images have been recorded or registered and which create the illusion of movement when projected, broadcast, or played back (by means of a projector, television set, computer, software or equivalent devices). Such images may or may not be accompanied by sound. The definition includes moving images of all types, e.g., features, shorts, news footage, trailers, outtakes, screen tests, educational and training documentaries, experimental or independent productions, study films or video, home movies, unedited materials, television broadcasts, commercials, spot announcements, recorded performances of concerts, ballets, plays, and CCTV footage etc. It encompasses both live action and animation and includes all analogue and digital formats.

While many moving image archives also have audio materials in their collections, this manual does not offer detailed guidance for describing audio media. However, the Manual does provide ways to describe physical and technical characteristics of analogue and digital audio items to assist with collection and preservation management.

1.1.3 Use

Instead of defining levels of cataloguing, this manual outlines core elements for moving image description. The core elements provide the basis for identification of a resource and for facilitating the exchange of data from one system to another. These are not “core” elements in the sense of a Dublin Core, EBUCore, or PBCore schema, but are rather intended to illustrate common elements that are used in describing moving images and are referenced in the rules outlined in this manual. The elements are largely drawn from EN 15744 and 15907. For a comparison of elements described in this Manual and EN 15907, please see [Appendix G, Elements of Description comparison](#).

This manual also provides a list of all the data elements associated with the entities described. Thus, this approach provides a framework for the minimum and maximum amount of descriptive information allowed in a range of moving image cataloguing activities existing in a large variety of environments.

Institutions are encouraged to include as many of the non-core elements as goals and circumstances permit. None are considered mandatory by these guidelines, but an institution may require that some are mandatory for internal purposes.

1.2 Core elements of description ¹

These core points of description are listed with their corresponding terms as presented in the manual. They represent an ideal minimum set of metadata for moving image cataloguing.

CORE CONCEPT	TOP-LEVEL ELEMENT	SUB-ELEMENT
Title	1.3.2 Title [Work]	–

¹Adapted from CEN TC 372 EN 15744 element set

CORE CONCEPT	TOP-LEVEL ELEMENT	SUB-ELEMENT
Series / Serial ²	1.3.2 Title [Work]	1.3.2.1 Title Type = Series/Serial [Work]
Cast	1.4.1 Agents (e.g. Cast, Credits, Person, Organisation, etc.) [Work]	1.4.1.1 Agent Activity = Cast [Work]
Credits (including Production Companies)	1.4.1 Agents [Work]	1.4.1.1 Agent Activity = Credit (use term for actual role) [Work]
Country of Reference	1.3.3 Country of reference [Work]	
*Original Format	2.3.4 Format of a moving image Manifestation [Manifestation]	2.3.4.1.2 Specific Carrier Type: [Manifestation]
*Original Length	2.3.5 Extent of a Manifestation [Manifestation]	2.3.5.2 Physical extent of a Manifestation
*Original Duration	2.3.5 Extent of a Manifestation [Manifestation]	2.3.5.3 Duration of a Manifestation
*Original Language	1.3.5 Language(s) [Work]	1.3.5.1 Language Term + 1.3.5.2 Usage type [Work]
Year of Reference	1.3.4 Year/Date of reference [Work]	1.3.4.1 Date Type [Work]
Identifier	As appropriate: 1.3.1 Work/Variant Identifier [Work/Variant] &/OR 2.3.1 Identifier [Manifestation] &/OR 3.1.1 Identifier [Item]	As appropriate: 1.3.1.1 Identifier Type [Work/Variant] &/OR 2.3.1.1 Identifier Type [Manifestation] &/OR 3.1.1.1 Identifier Type [Item]
Subject/Genre/Form ³	1.4.3 Subject/Genre/Form terms [Work]	
Content Description	1.3.6 Content description (synopses, shotlists, etc)	

The concept of “original” in this manual indicates the first known manifestation of the Work, which is not determined by its release status. The concept of “original” must be flexible enough to be applied to released and unreleased Works. For a released Work, we tend to refer to the “original” Work as the first known release of the first known manifestation. For Works that are not released (e.g., a home movie), the “original” Work is simply the first known manifestation.

See [Appendix I.1 Example 1. Feature film in 3-level, 2-level and 1-level hierarchies](#) as an illustration.

Please see [Appendix G, Elements of Description](#) comparison for a list of all elements described in this manual.

NOTE: For exchanging data, indicating the origin of the record is important (i.e., name of the institution supplying the record). This data is typically located in a dedicated field at the Work level and automatically generated by electronic systems. This corresponds to CEN EN 15907, 6.2 – Record Source.

²EN15744 definitions “A series is a group of separate items related to one another by the fact that each item bears, in addition to its own title, a collective title applying to the group as a whole. A serial is a type of “short subject” work which is characterized principally by the episodic development of a story”. This Core Concept is referencing the name of another Work that a Work may be “part of”, where the latter has been conceived within the context/intention of being an element of a Series or Serial. It is not being used here as a Work/Variant Description Type. (See D.1 Work/Variant Description Types)

³Form = Fiction, Non-fiction, etc. Some institutions may incorporate these as a genre term, whilst others may have them as a separate category to genre.

1.3 Elements of description across Works, Variants, Manifestations, and Items

This section includes sample structures for how the elements can be applied across Works, Variants, Manifestations, and Items. Four models are provided, beginning with the more complete four-level model and ending with a simple one-level model. Models should be applied according to an institution's system and also determined by the amount of information known about an Item.

The full list of elements of description for each entity is set out in the following charts and diagrams, and in Chapters 1-3. See Appendix I, Examples of records containing core elements in the different levels of hierarchy for examples of real records which contain these core elements (as well as others) across the hierarchies.

TODO insert new diagrams here

Work/Manifestation/Item. Properties expressed in one record, with abstracts, contextual and object data stored in a single level hierarchy Distribution of the elements of description according to the four entities order

Properties	(Work)	(Manifestation)	(Item)
Titles	Uniform, Preferred, Other Title information, Alternative, Supplied/Devised	Title proper	Title proper
Part	Monographic, Analytic, Serial, Collection		
Content	Categories: fiction/non fiction; genre, synopsis, subject, etc.		
Dates/Events	Creation, Production, Censorship, Copyright	Release, manufacture, transmission, distribution, etc.	Object creation, acquisition, accession, de-accession, loan, transport, etc.
Agents	Cast, credits, rights holders, creator, etc.	Distributor, broadcaster, publisher	Donor, Archive/archivist, technician, restorer, etc.
Rights context	Copyright holder and date	Platforms, territories, dates. Agents (distributors, license holder)	Transfer of ownership
Event types	Awards Censorship Production IPR registration	Pre-release, theatrical, non-theatrical, transmission, home viewing, internet, not for release, censorship etc.	Acquisition Reproductions Disposal
Format general		35mm film, digital cinema, blu ray, etc.	
Format specific			16mm film pos, 35mm lavender separation, ProRes422 HQ, etc.

Properties	(Work)	(Manifestation)	(Item)
Condition report			Pristine, not for projection, heavy scratches, etc.
Storage location			Home location, current location, previous location
Conservation recommendations			Urgent transfer required, relocate sub-zero, etc.

1.4 Sources of Information

Information entered in a record must be derived from a source. Acceptable sources of information for moving image Works, Variants, Manifestations and Items include primary and secondary sources.

Primary sources include information on the actual Item itself. For example, for film materials, titles and main production credits are transcribed from the frames usually in the opening credits. Secondary sources include information written on containers and reference materials.

Although primary sources are generally preferred, this manual allows for the use of secondary sources no matter the entity, attribute or relationship described in recognition that there may be constraints on the amount of research or viewing a cataloguer can do.

Whether information is taken from primary and/or secondary sources as listed in the following, indicate that fact either by means of a note or by some other means (e.g., through coding or the use of square brackets, specific fields, or links to other databases).⁴ Add the source of the information in a Note field and include the element name. Cite each individual source of information using an agreed upon, consistently applied citation style, such as The Chicago Manual of Style, or other style guide.

Primary source information can be derived from:

- a) the title frame(s) or title screen(s)⁵
- b) embedded metadata in textual form that contains a title (e.g., metadata embedded in an MPEG video file)⁶
- c) an eye-readable label bearing a title that is permanently printed on or affixed to the resource (excluding accompanying textual material or a container)⁷
- d) accompanying material or a container issued as part of the resource itself⁸
- e) a container that is not issued as part of the resource itself (e.g., a box, case made by the owner)⁹
- f) other published descriptions of the resource¹⁰
- g) any other available source (e.g., a reference source)¹¹

Examples:

⁴Based on RDA 2.2.4 Other Sources of Information

⁵RDA 2.20.2.3 Title Source

⁶Ibid.

⁷Adapted from RDA 2.2.2.3 Resources Consisting of Moving Images

⁸Based on RDA 2.2.4 Other Sources of Information

⁹RDA 2.2.4 Other Sources of Information

¹⁰Ibid.

¹¹Ibid.

Credit information derived from:
AFI Catalog of Feature Films: 1930-1939.

Title derived from film opening credits.

1.5 Display issues

Although these guidelines are primarily focused on content, many users may also welcome some guidance in data presentation. Section 0.4 gathers some of the common display questions with recommendations.

1.5.1 Punctuation

These guidelines do not mandate the use of any particular data presentation standard, such as ISBD punctuation. However, ISBD punctuation is recommended if punctuation guidance is desired. Please consult ISBD¹² for general guidance and examples, or the FIAF Cataloguing Rules for Film Archives (1991)¹³.

These guidelines do advocate consistent usage where punctuation is needed as a cataloguing construction, for example, to separate Form elements in the creation of Partially or Fully Supplied/Devised Titles e.g.

Example:

Jaws. Rushes

For transcribed elements, record punctuation as found. For all other elements, record punctuation as found on the source(s) of information.

1.5.2 Capitalisation and Articles

Some institutions render Work titles in capitals – all upper-case – as a simple typographical method of identifying these key items of information, while others only capitalise the first letter of a title, in accordance with ISBD. Either usage is permitted by these guidelines, although institutions may prefer to retain the conventional practice of capitalising only the first letter of a title and any proper names as dictated by the usage of the language in which the information is given.

Users should recognise that using all capitals may create problems in the future when reformatting to mixed case if preferred in a new system, or when reformatting to mixed caps for display in a web platform where mixed caps is increasingly preferred. Although it is possible to automate the conversion of upper case to mixed caps, that automation cannot easily manage linguistic complexities or semantic rules and exceptions such as proper nouns, or place names. Therefore, it is recommended that an institution transition to ISBD capitalisation when and where possible.

When an “all capitals” practice is followed, institutions have the additional option of reducing to lower case words which are of minor importance to the substantive title (for filing purposes, etc.), such as sub-titles, a definite or indefinite article appearing as the first word of a title, etc. Experience has shown that this practice can make it easier for staff in institutions handling multi-lingual material to recognise, for filing purposes and interpretation, the different significance of words that are articles in one language but not in others.

While the guidelines permit both cases, it is recommended where permitted now or in the future, to use the conventional practice of capitalising only the first letter of a title and other letters as dictated by the usage of the language in which the information is given. Leading articles

¹²http://www.ifla.org/files/assets/cataloguing/isbd/isbd-cons_20110321.pdf

¹³http://www.fiafnet.org/~fiafnet/uk/publications/fep_cataloguingRules.html

should ideally be placed in separate fields in keeping with the way systems are being developed for alphabetical sorting. Alternatively some systems (for example, those containing MARC21 records) indicate the number of non-filing characters to skip in alphabetization.

Examples:

Alternative practices | ISBD practice:

Die Hard | Die hard

Die DREIGROSCHENOPER | Die Dreigroschenoper

LES PATTERSON SAVES THE WORLD | Les Patterson saves the world

Les MISERABLES | Les misérables

American in Paris, An | An American in Paris

MARC21 tag example:

245 03 An American in Paris

1.6 Language and script of the description

The language of the original Work can be different from the language of a Manifestation or Item. For example, the original Work title can be in the original creation language, but the item being catalogued is a Variant with the title and key credits in a different language. Where possible, data elements in the catalogue record for the Work are recorded in the language and/or script of the original Work and may be transcribed from the Item of an original manifestation of the Work or taken from other sources.

This will primarily be for data transcribed from the screen, e.g. Title and key agents (director, producer, cast, etc.). Do not confuse this with describing the language of the soundtrack, which is noted in specific language fields.

Data elements for the Variant, Manifestation and Item are recorded in the language that is on the Variant, Manifestation or Item and should be transcribed from the Item or from other sources in the appropriate language. Scripts, symbols or other characters that cannot be transcribed as presented or are other than that used by the cataloguing agency or institution may, if necessary, be transliterated in the script of the institution or replaced with a cataloguer's description. Use a recognised standard for transliteration such as [ISO 9 for Cyrillic characters](#), [Pinyin for Chinese characters](#), or [ALA-LC Romanization Tables](#). Give an explanatory note for the addition, if necessary. Optionally, enclose the cataloguer's description in square brackets.

Example:

Original Chinese Title: 英雄榜

Transliterated Pinyin Title: Jīng wǔ yǐngxióng

English Translated Title: Fist of Legend

1.7 Abbreviations

For transcribed data elements, transcribe abbreviations as found. For all other elements, generally do not abbreviate words. Optionally, additional non-preferred title types may also be added to assist in user searching and accessibility (see [Appendix A, Titles and Title Types](#)).

1.8 Examples

The examples given throughout the guidelines are illustrative and not prescriptive (unless stated otherwise). They follow The Chicago manual of style¹⁴ for the sake of consistency. They are intended to illuminate the provisions of the guidelines to which they are attached, rather than

¹⁴University of Chicago. 2003. The Chicago manual of style. Chicago, Ill: University of Chicago Press.

to extend those provisions. Therefore, neither the examples nor the form in which they are presented should be taken as instructions, unless the accompanying text specifically states that they should. Most examples are from actual titles; in the few made-up examples an attempt has been made to formulate realistic data. Examples of complete entries may be found in [Appendix I, Examples of records containing core elements in the different levels of hierarchy](#). Examples of the elements of description in different data structures are shown in [Appendix G, Elements of Description comparison](#). The bibliography follows ISO 690.

1.9 Errors

As these guidelines recognise the importance of researched information in the catalogue entry, unintentional errors or inaccuracies from the Item should not be reproduced at the Work or Variant levels.

Begin with what the source of information says and correct it only when it is known to be ambiguous or erroneous. Correction must be done in such a way that the resource remains recognisable to the users unaware of the error.¹⁵ For example, AACR2 recommends transcribing the error followed by “sic” and sometimes the correct text in square brackets.

Example:

Title (Work): À bout de souffle
Title (Item): À bout de soufflee [sic]

OR

Title (Work): À bout de souffle
Title (Item): À bout de soufflee [souffle]

In RDA, the title is provided as transcribed without a recognition of the misspelling, with the correct title added in a secondary set of Title and Title Type fields (see [A.2.4.1 Alternative title types](#)) and a Note explaining the misspelling.

Example:

Title (Work): À bout de souffle
Title (Item): À bout de soufflee
Title (Item): À bout de souffle
TitleType (Item): Actual title
Note: Title on item is misspelled.

Missing information required to understand and identify a Manifestation, Variant, or Item can be supplied in brackets.

Record intentionally misspelled words as found.

Example:

Title (Work): Inglorious Basterds

1.10 Alternatives and options

Certain of the individual guidelines or parts of guidelines in this manual are introduced by the words, “alternatively” or “optionally.” Optional provisions arise from the recognition that different solutions to a problem and differing levels of detail and specificity are appropriate in different

¹⁵YCR, Principle 3, p.4.

contexts. Some alternatives and options should be decided as a matter of cataloguing policy for a particular catalogue or archive and should therefore be exercised either always or never. Other alternatives and options should be exercised case-by-case. It is recommended that all institutions which undertake cataloguing distinguish between these two types of options and keep a record of their policy decisions and of the circumstances in which a particular option may be applied.

The necessity for judgment and interpretation by the cataloguer is recognised in these guidelines. Such judgment and interpretation may be based on the requirements of a particular catalogue or upon the use of the items being catalogued. The need for judgment is indicated in these guidelines by phrases such as "if appropriate," "if important" and "if necessary." These indicate recognition of the fact that uniform regulation of catalogues is neither possible nor desirable, and encourage the application of individual judgment based on specific local knowledge. This statement in no way contradicts the value of standardisation. Such judgments must be applied consistently within a particular context and must be documented by the individual archive.

In addition, adherence to these structures and standards may not be wholly appropriate or possible for some institutions, given the differences in current practice, available cataloguing tools, and other issues. An attempt has been made to design guidelines that can be applied where feasible, but which are not meant to be prescriptive.

2 Moving Image Works

TODO: update all links with `nameref`

TODO: Check that label `sec` for sections are unique

TODO: footnote syntax, after or before period

TODO: example syntax, italics or bulletpoints.

2.1 Definitions¹⁶

Brief definitions of the standard CEN terms Work/Variant/Manifestation/Item used in the Manual were provided at the end of the Introduction (see [Introduction](#)). This and the following sections provide in-depth definitions of the terms as used in these guidelines, beginning with the highest level in the description hierarchy: Moving Image Works and Variants.

2.1.1 Moving Image Work

A moving image Work comprises both the intellectual or artistic content and the process of realisation in a cinematographic medium, e.g., what it is called, when it was made, who made it, who was in it, what it is about, etc.

A Work as a conceptual entity is the topmost level of description. It may be published or unpublished, complete (whole) or incomplete (unfinished or missing content), edited or unedited. It is intended to function as the “node” that relates all Variants and Manifestations of a Work to a common creation. A Work contains the characteristics that are inherited across any Variant, Manifestation, or Item derived from that Work. It also reflects the original intentions of its realisation, including: circumstances of the creation process such as date(s) and place(s) of production, most contributions by agents such as directors, screenwriters, production companies and cast members, as well as certain statements about the contents.¹⁷

The concept of moving image Work includes moving image realisations of events or performances – such as edited or unedited recordings of a play or concert performed in a theatre, a sporting event, a street performer, a medical procedure, etc.

In addition, moving images created by use of automatic devices such as surveillance cameras or vehicle-mounted cameras, can also be considered moving image works if they are subject to collecting or publishing activities.

The presence of artistic intent in the creation of a moving image entity is not a prerequisite for considering it a moving image Work. A moving image entity can be considered as a Work on a very broad spectrum of creative intent, from the classic fiction feature film at one extreme (with artistic input from dozens or hundreds of creative contributors), through amateur film (with a modicum of creative intent by one individual), to CCTV footage or other automatic recording outputs at the other extreme.

Works may have one-to-many relationships with instances of Variant and Manifestation/Item and many-to-many relationships with instances of Agent(s), Event(s), Content(s), Subject(s) and Other Relation(s).¹⁸

Works include:

Moving Image realisations based on new scripts or adapted from pre-existing textual works such as novels, plays, etc.

Examples:

Hamlet (UK, 1948, Laurence Olivier)
Hamlet (United States of America, 1996, Kenneth Branagh)

Les misérables (France, 1958, Jean-Paul Le Chanois)
Les misérables (United States of America, 1998, Bille August)

Trollflöjten (Sweden, 1975, Ingmar Bergman)
Il flauto magico (Italy, 1976, Giulio Gianini and Emanuele Luzzati)

¹⁶For a discussion of other definitions of the “Work” and Variant entities, see [Moving Image Works](#).

¹⁷Adapted from the definition of a Cinematographic Work in EN 15907, 4.1.1, p.8.

¹⁸Ibid.

Tosca (Italy, 1939, Karl Koch)
Tosca (Italy, 1973, Luigi Magni)

Moving Image realisations of scheduled performances or events such as concerts, original theatre performances, sports events, etc.¹⁹ These are distinguished from cinematically staged theatrical or musical events for the purpose of creating a unique moving image work such as the Tosca and Hamlet examples provided above.

Examples:

Simon and Garfunkel: The Concert in Central Park (United States of America, 1982, Michael Lindsay-Hogg)

Olympia 1. Teil – Fest der Völker (Germany, 1938, Leni Riefenstahl)
Olympia 2. Teil – Fest der Schönheit (Germany, 1938, Leni Riefenstahl)

Marathon (Spain, 1992, Carlos Saura)

Moving Images created by use of automatic devices such as surveillance cameras, scientific or medical instruments, etc.²⁰

Examples²¹:

Birmingham Town Hall Car Park. Camera 7. (United Kingdom, 2015, NCP)

University College Hospital. Endoscopy – Colonscope. Patient HX3456. 2010 (United Kingdom, 2010, University College Hospital)

2.1.2 Moving Image Variant ²²

A moving image Variant is an entity that may be used to indicate any change to content-related characteristics that do not significantly change the overall content of a Work as a whole. Such Variants can be produced by minor additions, deletions or substitutions to the content. As a general guideline, changes that would result in a different content description should be treated as a separate Work rather than a Variant.

Changes that could be described as Variants are detailed below, in **1.1.2 Boundaries between Moving Image Works and Variants**, and may include the addition of subtitles, dubbing, and editing as a result of censorship or adjustment of duration, e.g. for TV programming. For institutions that have made a policy decision not to use the Variant, these changes may constitute Manifestation differences.

The determination of a Variant requires human analysis, and as such is an interpretative practice. It is not always easy to establish what the Variants may be. For example, an institution may have a television recording of a motion picture broadcast but no way of comparing it with an original theatrical copy as to whether it has been altered in terms of subtle censorship of content or duration

Therefore, this entity is optional. If employed, each instance of a Variant is related to a Work and can have one-to-many relationships with instances of Manifestation(s), and many-to-many

¹⁹Adapted from the definition of a Cinematographic Work in EN 15907, 4.1.1, p.8.

²⁰Ibid.

²¹These are invented examples for illustrative purposes

²²Adapted from EN 15907, 4.2 Variant.

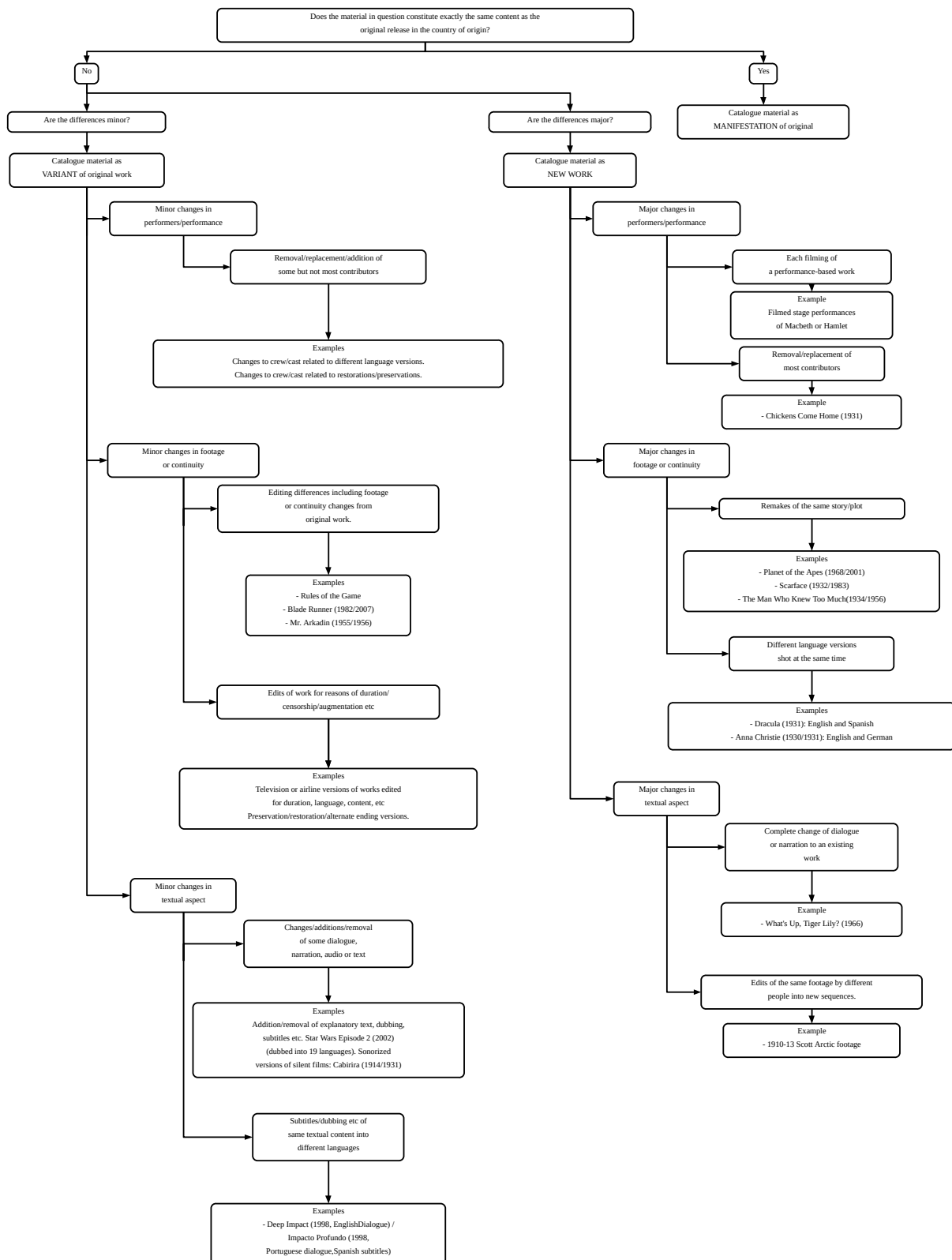
relationships with Event(s), Agent(s) and Other Relation(s). If no Variant of a Work exists or is known to exist, then this entity can be omitted, connecting an instance of a Work with one or more instances of Manifestation.

2.2 Boundaries between Works and Variants

This section looks at instances of when an entity constitutes a new Work or a Variant of a Work.

Determining boundaries between Works and Variants may sometimes rely upon a cataloguer's judgment, however, in general: If much of the original textual material remains, most of the original footage remains in roughly the same continuity, however abridged, and substantially most of the contributors are the same, the existence of alterations more often than not constitute a Variant, rather than a new Work. An institution will need to set internal policies defining the minimum percentage of a work that has been extensively edited to qualify it as a new Work.

This decision tree is intended to help cataloguers determine when changes in content warrant the creation of a new Work record or a new Variant record. This distinction applies to cataloguing structures using a 4-level hierarchy: Work, Variant, Manifestation, and Item. When using a 3-level hierarchy - Work, Manifestation, and Item - minor changes will indicate new Manifestations rather than new Variants. In all cases, major changes warrant the creation of new Work records.



2.2.1 Boundaries between Works

These guidelines recognise that real world cataloguing needs and data structures necessitate practical applications of conceptual modelling. To that end, the recommendations made in this chapter about determining boundaries for Works and Variants are based on an approach that emphasizes effective, efficient and economic data creation and maintenance: information that is common to all realisations of a Work or Variant is recorded once and is comprised of the shared

information that will not change (for example, title, original creation date, creator, etc.). The Work description or record contains the index terms for describing a Work in the catalogue and fulfills the functions of disambiguation (distinguishes Works containing similar or identical titles) and collocation (brings together all the materials that are related to the Work and all Variants of a given Work). Variations in information describing the Work result in Variants or Manifestations, or new Works.

The boundaries between one Work and another (i.e. where a new Work would be created rather than a Variant) are drawn on the basis of the following alterations to the content:²³

Change in footage and/or changes in continuity (primary editing)²⁴

Remakes of the same story/plot.

Examples:

The man who knew too much (UK, 1934, Alfred Hitchcock)
The man who knew too much (USA, 1956, Alfred Hitchcock)

T'amerò sempre (Italy, 1933, Mario Camerini)
T'amerò sempre (Italy, 1943, Mario Camerini)

Planet of the apes (United States of America, 1968, Franklin J. Schaffner)
Planet of the apes (United States of America, 2001, Tim Burton)

Scarface (United States of America, 1932, Howard Hawks)
Scarface (United States of America, 1983, Brian De Palma)

Die Dreigroschenoper (Germany, 1931, Georg Wilhelm Pabst)
Die Dreigroschenoper (Germany, 1962, Wolfgang Staudte)

Different language versions shot at the same time, released simultaneously, sometimes with different casts.

Examples:

Dracula (United States of America, 1931, Tod Browning, Spanish and English)

Anna Christie (United States of America, 1930, Clarence Brown, English; 1931, German)

Der Fangschuß (France/Germany, 1976, Volker Schlöndorff, German)
Le Coup de grâce (France/Germany, 1976, Volker Schlöndorff, French)

Die Dreigroschenoper (Germany, 1931, Georg Wilhelm Pabst, German)
L'opéra de quat'sous (France, 1931, Georg Wilhelm Pabst, French)

²³The types of alterations given here are adapted from Yee, "The Concept of Work for Moving Image Materials."

²⁴Secondary editing results in a Variant.

La canzone dell'amore (United States of America, 1930, Gennaro Righelli, English)
Liebeslied (Germany, 1930, Constantin J. Davis, German)
La dernière berceuse (France, 1930, Jean Cassagne, French)

Editing of the same raw footage by different people into different sequences.

Example:

Several separate Works made from the footage taken on Captain Robert Falcon Scott's Antarctic expedition, 1910-13.

Change in textual or spoken word aspect

Complete alteration of dialogue and/or narration of an existing work.

Example:

What's Up Tiger Lily (1966)

Change in performance/performers

Each cinematographic realisation of a dramatic work.

Examples:

Moving image representations of theatrical performances of Shakespeare's Macbeth, where there is removal and/or replacement of substantially most of the contributors (e.g., cast and/or crew), associated with a work

Chickens Come Home (1931) where the film was first shot in English, then re-shot with Spanish dialogue and additional Spanish-speaking actors.

If much of the original textual or spoken word material remains, most of the original footage remains in roughly the same continuity, however abridged, and substantially most of the contributors are the same, the existence of alterations more often than not constitute a Variant, rather than a new Work.

2.2.2 Boundaries between Works and Variants/Manifestations

The boundaries between a moving image Work and its Variant(s) (i.e. where a Variant rather than a new Work may be created) may be drawn on the basis of one or more of the following alterations to the content given below.²⁵

Change in footage and/or change in continuity (secondary editing)

Different footage used from the original realisation of the Work, even where footage used was shot at the same time and edited together by the same people, or following the pattern set by original creators.

Examples²⁶:

The rules of the game (1939): exists only as a Variant of the original Work, made partially from alternate takes to those used in the original release.

²⁵The types of alterations given here are adapted from Yee, "The Concept of Work for Moving Image Materials."

²⁶Il cinema ritrovato 2006. 20. edizione: sabato 1 luglio-sabato 8 luglio / Cineteca del Comune di Bologna. – Bologna : Cineteca del Comune di Bologna, 2006, p. 154 (Dossier Mr. Arkadin)

Various re-edited releases of Blade Runner (1982, 1986, 1992, 2007)

Mr. Arkadin (France-Spain-Switzerland, 1955, Orson Welles): eight different Variants between 1955 and 1956, each one with differences in footage and editing. Among them, three have the title Confidential Report.

Editing of a Work to create realisations that are shorter in extent/duration.

Examples:

Große Freiheit Nr. 7 (Germany, 1944) (112 minutes)
Shortened Variant Große Freiheit Nr. 7 (109 minutes)

Works censored or edited for television broadcast, for showing on airplanes, for showing in different parts of the country/world, etc.

Annie Leibovitz, Life through a Lens (United States of America, 2007-01-03), broadcast in TV series American Masters
Shortened Variant (for British television): Annie Leibovitz, Life through a Lens (UK, 2008-06-10), broadcast in TV series Imagine

Last Tango in Paris (United States of America, 1972, Bernardo Bertolucci)
Censored Variant: Ultimo tango a Parigi (Italy, 1988, Broadcast)

Addition of new footage to a Work to update informational/educational content; for preservation/restoration; to offer different endings or alternate takes.

Examples:

Blackmail (UK, 1929, Alfred Hitchcock)
Augmented Variant: United Kingdom– 1929 (longer, with some scenes shot on purpose)

Little Shop of Horrors (United States of America, 1986, Frank Oz)
Augmented Variant: alternate ending of 23 minutes, included in the 2012 Warner Home Video – Blu-ray, DVD edition

Nosferatu. Eine Symphonie des Grauens (Germany, 1922, Friedrich Wilhelm Murnau)
Preservation/Restoration Variant: restoration by Friedrich-Wilhelm Murnau-Stiftung; Luciano Berriatù (restorer) – Germany – 2005/6 (reconstruction based on different sources)

Change in textual aspect

Partial alteration of dialogue and/or narration of an existing Work, including the removal and/or addition of dialogue (audio and/or intertitles).

Examples²⁷:

²⁷Some institutions may have the 19 foreign language versions as 19 separate Manifestations, rather than create 19 Variant records, particularly if the data relating to specific different dubbing credits is unavailable or deemed of minor importance.

The addition or removal of explanatory text, dubbing, subtitles, etc.
Star Wars Episode II: Attack of the Clones (2002) was dubbed into 19 foreign language versions, which were released on the same date as the English language version.

Cabiria (Italy, 1914, Giovanni Pastrone)
Sonorized Variant: Italy, 1931

A dog's life (United States of America, 1918, Charles Chaplin)
Sonorized Variant: Vita da cani – sonorized with Italian intertitles – 193?

The yellow mask (United States of America, 1930, Harry Lachman)
Augmented Variant: Il principe corsaro – 1931: only with music, songs and sound effects, plus new Italian intertitles, but without dialogue, according to a 1930 law, which involved the first spoken foreign films distributed in Italy.

Hallelujah! (United States of America, 1929, King Vidor)
Augmented Variant: Alleluia! – addition of music, songs, sound effects, and new Italian intertitles, but without dialogue; Italy, 1930

La presa di Roma (Italy, 1905)
Preservation/restoration Variant: addition of stills and explanation texts; Italy, 2007.
Restoration by Centro Sperimentale di Cinematografia-Cineteca Nazionale

Change in performance/performers

Removal and/or replacement and/or addition of any one or more of the contributors (e.g., cast and/or crew), but not substantially most, associated with a Work.

Examples of restored versions of works which include credits for the responsible individuals and institutions:

Nosferatu. Eine Symphonie des Grauens (Germany, 1922, Friedrich Wilhelm Murnau)
Preservation/augmented Variant – 2005/6: restoration by the Friedrich-Wilhelm Murnau-Stiftung; Luciano Berriatù (restorer)

Die freudlose Gasse (Germany, 1925, Georg Wilhelm Pabst);
Preservation/augmented Variant – Germany – 2008. Digitale Restaurierung: Filmarchiv Austria, Wien, Stephanie Gratzner in Zusammenarbeit mit der Galerie Krems; Wissenschaftliche Beratung: Stephan Droessler, Nikolaus Wostry; Projectleitung: Ernst Kleininger, Nikolaus Wostry (from the credits on the DVD)

Kita-kitsune Monogatari (Japan, 1978, Koreyoshi Kurahara); original narrator voice: Eiji Okada; Augmented variant with added prologue and English narration: The Glacier Fox in Search of the Northern Sun – United States of America – 1979: narrator voice: Arthur Hill.

Examples of language versions which credit the individuals responsible for dubbing or subtitles:

Senso (Italy, 1954, Luchino Visconti)
Subtitled Variant: French subtitles – 1955: subtitles by Georges Sadoul

Cinderella (United States of America, 1950, Clyde Geronimi, Wilfred Jackson, Hamilton Luske)
Dubbed variant: Cendrillon, French (spoken language) – France – 1991: Dominique Poulain, voice of Cinderella)

Sons of the Desert (United States of America, 1933, William A. Seiter):
Dubbed Variant 1: I figli del deserto – Italian (spoken language) – 1935: Carlo Cassola, voice of Oliver Hardy;
Dubbed Variant 2: I figli del deserto – Italian (spoken language) 1946: Alberto Sordi, voice of Oliver Hardy.

When an institution has set a policy not to use Variants, the boundaries will usually be between a Work and Manifestations, i.e., a new Manifestation linked to the Work would be created rather than a Variant, or else a separate new Work, depending on assessment of the level of change or variation.

Boundaries for this decision are akin to the concepts of “versions with major changes” and “variations with minor changes” in the FIAF Cataloguing Rules for Film Archives (1991) <http://www.fiafnet.org/pages/E-Resources/FIAF-Cataloguing-Rules.html>

Example:

Our herring industry (GB, 1932) is the shortened version of Drifters (GB, 1929).

Where a Work/Variant structure exists then Our herring industry would constitute a Variant of the Work Drifters.

Where no Variant structure exists then the cataloguer would decide whether it constituted a Manifestation or new Work.

It is up to every archive or institution to choose and make its own policy on whether to use Variants or Manifestations.

2.2.3 Boundaries between Variants

It is possible for a moving image Variant to be modified in such a way as to create a new Variant related to the previous one²⁸. The boundaries between one Variant and another may be drawn on the basis of the following alterations to the content:²⁹

Change in continuity (secondary editing)

Revision or modification of already edited footage of completed work.

Example³⁰:

In 2007, some in-flight showings of The Queen (2006) distributed to Delta and other airlines had all references to the word “God” edited out by an overzealous and inexperienced employee.

Abridgements or additions to existing content.

Example³¹: a release of a dubbed film abridged or augmented

²⁸YCR, Expressions of Expressions, p. 47

²⁹The types of alterations given here are adapted from Yee, “The Concept of Work for Moving Image Materials.”

³⁰Cornick, Michael. (2008). Modern Film Censorship: Television, Airlines, and Home Entertainment. p. 44

³¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Leopard

Il gattopardo (Italy, France, 1963, Luchino Visconti)
Dubbed/ Abridged: The leopard, English (spoken language) -1963 – United States of America – 161' (Theatrical distribution in United States of America, the 20th Century Fox cut 45 minutes); Subtitled: The leopard, English (spoken language) -1980 – United States of America (reintegrates the original running time of 187').

Change in textual and spoken word aspect

Same dialogue and/or narration rendered in different spoken, sung or written languages.

Example of a release of a foreign film (dubbed), subtitled in a different language:

Die kleine und die grosse Liebe (Germany, 1938, Joseph von Backy)
Dubbed/Subtitled Variant: Il piccolo e il grande amore, Italian (spoken language), English (subtitles) – Italy – 1938

Change in performance/performers

Addition, removal and/or replacement of some of the contributors (e.g., cast and/or crew), associated with a Work.

Example³²:

The re-dubbed North American English version of the Japanese movie, Godzilla 2000: Millennium (1999), includes the following credits unique to this Variant:
Dubbing Director: Mike Schlesinger
Media: Cinema/TV/VHS/DVD
Dubbing Studio: Tristar Pictures/Sony Pictures Entertainment

TODO TABLE MISSING HERE.

If much of the original textual and spoken word material remains, most of the original footage remains in roughly the same continuity, however abridged, and substantially most of the contributors are the same, the existence of alterations more often than not constitute a new Variant, rather than a new Work.

2.3 Attributes of a Moving Image Work/Variant

2.3.1 Work/Variant Description Type³³

The description type establishes the general focus of the Work being catalogued, whether it is a complete Work in one part, a Work made up of several parts, or a physical group or collection of Works. Providing this information helps the cataloguer and user understand the context of the Work/Variant being described, and whether it has any relationships with other Works/Variants. For example, a television series could be catalogued as a Serial, which implies that there could be related Works (episodes) catalogued as Monographs.

Record the level of description of the work being catalogued, for example, "analytic," "monographic," "serial," etc., according to a controlled vocabulary. The terms used in this Manual are derived from traditional bibliographic cataloguing rules and from EN 15907 (and are defined in Appendix D.1), but an institution may choose to create its own list of terms. See [D.1 Work/Variant Description Types](#).

³²Information from IMDb and Wikipedia

³³EN 15907, 4.1.2 Attributes—description Level, p. 8; BFI CID Stylistics Manual, A.1.3 Filmographic Level, pp. 7-8

2.3.2 Variant Type³⁴

Identify and describe the kind of change from a Work that gives rise to any instance(s) of a Variant. Selection should be made from a controlled list of values. Examples: Censored; Dubbed; Subtitled; Edited for TV. See [D.2 Variant Type](#).

2.4 Elements of a Work/Variant

This section describes the metadata elements that can be used to describe a Work/Variant. It is up to each institution to choose which elements are most applicable to describe their collections and according to what their system can support.

This Manual recommends using the qualifier “Type” for several core elements if an institution’s system can support it. In these cases, “Type” is used to define the source, function or purpose of the value entered in the main element. Using a “Type” qualifier conforms to its use in Dublin Core and other Dublin Core-influenced standards such as EBUCore and PBCore. Examples of using “Type” include the Identifier, Title, Date, and Description elements.

2.4.1 Work/Variant Identifier

Create an unambiguous reference to the Work/Variant using a unique identifier and indicate the type of identifier. The identifier should be a numerical or alphanumerical reference. This identifier is for the content of the Work/Variant, not for a specific Item. Manifestations and Items have their own Identifiers, discussed in later sections. This Work/Variant Identifier is shared by all Manifestations and Items associated to the Work.

In a way, a unique Work/Variant Identifier can have more value than a Work’s Title. Titles can confuse through different spellings, translations, and are not unique (i.e., King Kong). An Identifier refers to a specific Work/Variant and provides clear disambiguation between Works when there is confusion.

There can be more than one Work/Variant unique identifier for the content. This commonly occurs when institutions have content assigned identifiers by various standards or distribution agencies (ISAN, EIDR), or a government or other official body in the archive’s country has assigned an identifier to the work. An institution will likely have its own internal Identifier as well, often auto-generated by an institution’s information or asset management system. For example, a Work/Variant may have these associated identifiers:

- International Standard Audiovisual Number (ISAN)³⁵
- EIDR (Entertainment Identifier Registry)³⁶
- VIAF (Virtual International Authority File).³⁷
- Locally-generated

Use what makes sense for your institution; there is no recommendation for one particular resource. However, it is recommended that at least one unique identifier be included in the record. It is critical that each Identifier be unique.

Examples³⁸:

Cabiria (Italy, 1914, Piero Fosco)
Work identifier – ISAN number: ISAN 0000-0000-7B37-0000-J-0000-0000-H

Volver (Spain, 2006, Pedro Almodovar)
Work identifier – ISAN number: ISAN 0000-0001-6B16-0000-Y-0000-0000-9

³⁴EN 15907, 4.2.2 Attributes of a Variant, variant type; YCR, 2.1.1 Nature of modification (change in content) of expression, p. 48

³⁵www.isan.org

³⁶www.eidr.org

³⁷www.viaf.org

³⁸Pietro Fosco is the pseudonym of Giovanni Pastrone used in the ISAN registration.

Metropolis (Germany, 1927, Fritz Lang)
Work identifier – VIAF number: 219448355

The boxer (United States, Ireland, 1997, Jim Sheridan)
Work identifier – EIDR number: 10.5240/5896-B203-017D-11A5-EB7F-W
Work identifier – ISAN number: 0000-0000-60A5-0000-E-0000-0000-W

2.4.1.1 Identifier Type

If an institution's system allows, a "Type" can be applied with an Identifier to define the source of the Identifier.

Example:

The boxer (United States, Ireland, 1997, Jim Sheridan)
Work identifier: 10.5240/5896-B203-017D-11A5-EB7F-W
Identifier type: EIDR
Work identifier: 0000-0000-60A5-0000-E-0000-0000-W
Identifier type: ISAN

2.4.2 Title

Record at least one title, identifying phrase, or name for the moving image Work or Variant. If your institution is applying the use of "Type" qualifiers, use "Title Type" to state the function of a particular title (see [1.3.2.1 Title Type](#) and [Appendix A, Titles and Title Types](#)).

Ideally, the record should at a minimum contain the "preferred title" (also referred to as "main" or "original" title) of the Work or Variant. Generally, it is the title of a moving image Work or Variant when first released, broadcast, published or transmitted (i.e. mounted online) in the country or countries of origin. It may differ from the title found on a particular manifestation of the Work or Variant; the actual title on the Manifestation is noted in the Manifestation Title element (see [2.3.2 Title](#)). See [A.2.0 Preferred](#) for additional information.

For creating titles for untitled or unidentified entities see [A.2.5 Supplied/Devised Titles](#). Television programmes and other types of content that are part of a series/serial should have both the series/serial title and the episode title included in the Work record. This may be via use of a "Title type" qualifier. See [A.2.6 Titles of series/serials](#) for other options

Examples:

Gone with the wind (United States of America, 1939, Victor Fleming)
Gone with the wind – Preferred Title of the Work
Via col vento – Variant title – Dubbed (Italian)
Gejaagd door de win – Variant title – Dubbed (Dutch)
Autant en emporte le vent – Variant title – Dubbed – (French)
風雲再起 – Variant title – Dubbed (Japanese)

Аленкий тsvetochek (USSR, 1952, Lev Atamanov)
Аленкий тsvetochek – Title of the Work
Alenkiy tsvetochek: Alternative (transliterated) title of Work/ Variant (Preferred title if systems don't use Cyrillic)
Feuerrotes Blümchen – Variant title – Dubbed (German)
The Scarlet Flower – Variant title – Dubbed (English)

La passeggiata (Italy, 1953, Renato Rascel)
La passeggiata – Preferred Title of the Work
La prospettiva – Alternative title (Working title)

Anathan (Japan, 1953, Joseph von Sternberg)
Anathan – Preferred Title of the Work
The saga of Anathan – Alternative Title of the Work/Variant

Mary Tyler Moore show – Series title
Chuckles bites the dust – Preferred title

See [Appendix A.1 Title](#) for fuller titling details and information.

See [Appendix E.4](#) for titling of Aggregates (e.g., compilations).

For guidance on wording, order, spelling, punctuation, accentuation and capitalisation, see [Chapter 0. Preliminary Notes](#).

For sources of information for the Title, see [0.3 Sources of Information](#)

2.4.2.1 Title Type

Where relevant for an institution, if the Work/Variant or Manifestation includes multiple titles, such as a title in another language for a dubbed or subtitled variant, record the relevant Variant titles and associate a “Title Type” to each title for differentiation between the various types of titles (see [Appendix A, Titles and Title Types](#)).

2.4.3 Country of Reference

Where known and applicable, record the geographic origin of the moving image Work/Variant. This should be the country or countries where the principal offices or production facilities of the production company or companies are located.³⁹ Where an official national certificate or designation of a Work exists, use this as the authoritative source, e.g., Italian government department designates what is officially an Italian film.⁴⁰ When more than one place is associated with a Work/Variant, choose the place(s) with primary importance.

For institutions who need or require specific ordering of country of reference then the following is a possible example of how this may be achieved.⁴¹

If the Work is a multi-national production, the countries added to the record should be in order of financial involvement. For example, an Austrian/Italian/French co-production where the Austrian production company/sponsors financed 60%, the Italian 25% and the French 15% then the order of the countries would be: Austria, Italy, France.

If it is not possible to establish clearly the financial percentages of each country’s involvement, then consider the nationality of the director of the title and/or the majority of personnel involved with the film and select that as being the main country of origin of the film.

If the production company has branches in more than one country, choose the one responsible for the production of the work.

If the Work is a multi-national production, with production companies in multiple countries, choose the predominant production company if known.

³⁹ EN 15907, 6.5 Country of Reference, p. 19

⁴⁰ The certification of “Italian nationality” is provided by the law/decreto 2004, n. 28, part. 5 (but already provided in the former law 1213/1965). According to the 2004 law, the biggest part of the cast and crew, the locations, and the technical facilities have to be Italian, and 30% of the budget has to be spent in Italy. There is a number of exceptions for artistic reasons and in case of co-productions.

⁴¹ This is the formula followed by the British Film Institute. BFI CID Stylistics Manual – 2nd Edition. A.8.1.

Record the country of origin using the full form of the country name, e.g. United Kingdom rather than UK, by taking the most suitable value(s) from a controlled list. This can be an in-house list but the use of a standard list such as ISO 3166⁴² is preferable. If ISO is used, apply the English Short Name that is associated to a code. Optionally, record the country code as found in ISO 3166-1-alpha 2.

If the country name has changed, record the name of the country as it was at the time of production, e.g., Czechoslovakia for a Work/Variant produced in 1970, but Czech Republic or Slovakia for one from 2012.⁴³

2.4.4 Year/Date of Reference

A year or fuller date (e.g., day/month/year) is essential to identifying a moving image Work and, where applicable, its Variants. A common use of year/date is chronological ordering of lists of Works and their Variants.⁴⁴ As explained below, these guidelines recommend, where possible, applying two qualifiers to a Date element: Date Type, and Date Precision.

There is no primary or “preferred” year or date except within the context of the type of Work and, where applicable, its Variants. That is, typically, an original date of release or broadcast is essential for identifying a moving image Work and its Variants. In the absence of a release or broadcast date, provide a year of creation or production.

Record any dates associated with the Work or its Variants formatted according to ISO 8601 or other available resources, such as EDTF (Extended Date Time Format). ISO 8601 prescribes that dates should be formatted hierarchically as Year-Month-Day, using this convention: YYYY-MM-DD. Example: 2015-07-04. This structure eliminates confusion when dates can be formatted with month before day or day before month (e.g., 07/04/2015 or 04/7/2015). Using the ISO format makes indexing and sorting more efficient. Using words (June 11, 2004), while perhaps user-friendly in its narrative construction, are difficult to index as dates. Mixing date formats causes confusion in data retrieval and for users!

Where full dates are not known use Year-Month YYYY-MM or just Year YYYY, as systems permit.

2.4.4.1 Date Type

The year or date should be associated with an event in the life cycle of the Work or its Variants (see 1.4.2 Events). If your system supports it, apply a “Date Type” qualifier to make the date or year purpose clear. Date Type terms should be derived from a controlled vocabulary. For a list of initial terms, see Appendix D.4 Event Types.

For Works and Variants, the date is typically related to events such as its creation, availability (i.e. publication, release, distribution, broadcast or transmission) or registration (e.g. for copyright or intellectual property purposes), or bestowal of an award.

More than one year or date may be associated with a Work or its Variants. For example, in the case of a Work comprising segments produced in different years (for example, a home movie); list the years, if known, e.g., 1955, 1956, 1959.⁴⁵

Similarly, a Work may have a production date of 1962, a copyright date of December 1963, and a first release date of January 1964. Apply the Date Type qualifier to clarify the purpose of each date.

2.4.4.2 Date Precision

⁴²http://www.iso.org/iso/home/standards/country_codes.htm

⁴³ISO 3166-3 Codes for the representation of names of countries and their subdivisions – Part 3: Code for formerly used names of countries, is available for purchase as a PDF on the ISO website: http://www.iso.org/iso/home/store/catalogue_tc/catalogue_detail.htm?csnumber=2130

⁴⁴EN 15907, 6.6 Year of Reference, p. 20

⁴⁵Irish Film Archive, p. 13.

Where possible, provide a “Date Precision” qualifier to note if the date is precise, approximate, estimated, or a range. EDTF also provides codes to denote precision. For example, an uncertain or approximate date may be formatted thus: 2004-06~-11 (year and month are approximate; day known). Using a Date Precision qualifier, this Date entry could be entered as:

Date: 2004-06-11

Date Type: Creation

Date Precision: Approximate

An institution may choose to use a precision qualifier for imprecise dates.

If ISO formatting and/or the Date Precision qualifier are not applied, then use consistent terms and formatting to note date approximations.

Examples⁴⁶:

TODO this is a table not examples.

1971 or 1972 One year or the other

1969?

Probable Year

1969?

Circa 1969 (with qualifying note to indicate date is probably 1969)

*Circa*1960

Approximate Year

Circa 1960

1960 circa

191- Decade certain

Decade 1910

1910 decade

191 – ?

Probable decade

1910 decade (with qualifying note to indicate that date is probable decade date)

⁴⁶FIAF, 3.5.4, p. 64

1910 decade (with qualifying note to indicate that date is probable decade date)

Example

Decade 1910

Example

1910 decade

Example

191 – ?

Probable decade

Example

1910 decade (with qualifying note to indicate that date is probable decade date)

Example

1910 decade (with qualifying note to indicate that date is probable decade date)

Decade 1910 (as above)

between 1906 and 1912 Use for time spans, the outside limits of which can be precisely determined

1906 1912 (where system has date start/ date end functionality)

In instances such as these, a note should be given which further explains the Date.

Example:

[Personal record. Eugene Meyer family. Family camping trip through the Canadian Rockies]. – US, 1926.

Note

Year from notes accompanying item, attached to inventory, and from Merlo Pusey's Eugene Meyer, (New York: Knopf, 1974), p.195

2.4.5 Language(s)

A moving image Work is conceived and presented in a particular language or set of languages. Changes to the original language(s), as in the case of dubbing, are considered minor changes and can constitute a Variant of a moving image Work.

Alternatively, such minor changes can constitute a new Manifestation of a moving image Work rather than a Variant. Institutions using cataloguing structures that do not distinguish Variant level information (for example, those that create records primarily at the Manifestation level), should apply this alternative. (See guidelines for language in a Manifestation: [2.3.3 Language](#))

Indicate the language(s) (e.g., Italian) and usage(s) (e.g., Italian intertitles) in which the moving image Variant/Manifestation is written, spoken or sung, if applicable. More than one language can occur in different forms, depending on how the content is expressed (e.g., French dialogue and English subtitles).

2.4.5.1 Language Term

Record the language(s) by taking the most suitable value(s) from a controlled list of languages.

This can be an in-house list but it is preferable to use a standard language list such as the ISO 639 codes, including ISO 639-2, 639-3 and 639-5 (<http://www.loc.gov/standards/iso639-2/langhome.html>).

Optionally, record the language code as found in ISO 639, where allowable.

If no language can be determined, the information can be omitted or indicated by a value of "unknown".

2.4.5.2 Usage Type

Record the usage type of a language (e.g. spoken, intertitles, subtitles, etc.) by taking the most suitable term from a controlled list elaborated in-house or referring to an existing authoritative list. See [D.6 Language Usage Types](#).

Optionally, record language usage type at the Manifestation/Item level (see [2.3.3 Language](#)). A value of "original" can be added to the Language element here to indicate that statements made about the language(s) for a particular Manifestation/Item are indicative of the language(s) of the "original" Work.⁴⁷

2.4.6 Content description (synopses, shotlists, etc)⁴⁸

Write a concise, objective, non-critical summary of the content of the moving image Work and/or Variant. Content descriptions can be synopses, brief TV guide-like one sentence description, shotlists, etc. There can be more than one type of content description in the record, e.g. it is possible to have both a shotlist and a synopsis.

The content description should be written in a style that is easy to read. It should not include technical terms, abbreviations, or allusions significant to a specialist audience. Avoid slang expressions and colloquialisms fashionable at the time of writing, and, where several cataloguers are viewing independently, they should, ideally, try to achieve a common written style. Descriptions should be objective and not include subjective commentary on the quality of the content. If acceptable summaries are already available in secondary sources, cataloguers may use these, instead of taking the time to prepare summaries of their own.^[^60] If using summaries exactly as written, put the summary in quotes and note the source of the summary.

Examples⁴⁹:

An historical drama set in 16th century England in which King Henry VIII divorces his wife, Catherine of Aragon, and marries Anne Boleyn, a former lady-in-waiting, who is in love with Sir Thomas Wyatt. After several years, Henry becomes infatuated with Lady Jane Seymour and arranges to have the innocent Anne found in a compromising situation with Sir Thomas. Anne is tried for infidelity, found guilty, and executed.

Donald Graham, millionaire ex-convict, plans revenge on society figure John Cabin Brand, whom he blames for the death of his daughter.

A content description may also be a shotlist or listing of the contents of an aggregate Work/Variant (see [Appendix E, Aggregates](#)). Shotlists are the ideal content description to have or aim to have, particularly for non-fiction moving images, but it is recognised that resources and accessibility mean this is not always possible or practical for an archive or institution.

⁴⁷The indication of "original" values at the Manifestation level follows EN 15907 attributes of a Manifestation, pp. 10-11

⁴⁸Adapted from YCR, 1.2.16 Summary of genre, form, and subject matter of work, p. 38.

⁴⁹FIAF 7.2.12. Summary

Examples⁵⁰:

Title: Pathe News

Excerpts No.6

Contents: "Newest U.S. Submarine Goes into Commission," Pathe News No. 60

1921

(160 ft.) – "Span of New Memorial Bridge to Connect N.H. and Maine," Pathe News No. 57

1923

(72 ft.) – "Celebrate 300th Anniversary of Settling of Portsmouth," Pathe News No. 69

1923

(99 ft.) – "World's Largest Sub Takes First Plunge," Pathe News No. 93

1927

, (c) 21Nov27; MP4478 (134 ft.) – "New Memorial Bridge between N.H. and Maine!" Pathe News No. 70

1923

(105 ft.) – "Launch Largest Submarine Cruiser," Pathe Sound News No. 1

1930

, (c) 29Dec29; MP1025 (80 ft.).

Title: Victorian Cinema: 4: Bamforth/Riley/Hepworth

Contents:

Weary Willie (1898) (78ft),

Catching the Milk Thief (1899) (140ft)

The Tramp and the Baby's Bottle (1899) (214ft),

Women's Rights (1899) (289ft),

A Kiss in the Tunnel (1899) (367ft),

Boy's Cricket Match and Fight (1900) (475ft),

...real examples shortened

End

⁵⁰FIAF 7.2.16. Contents

Title: Magnificent Reproductions of the Great Yorkshire Show in Bradford (1901)
Mitchell & Kenyon 641: Panning shot across a road to the Yorkshire Agricultural Society building with a diffuse crowd of people in front of the building. As the shot passes the building, a number of people can be seen sitting down, including mothers with babies and some older people (00.36). Cut to a close-up shot of the building, with a sign reading "The Yorkshire Agricultural Society. Established 1837" (00.45). Cut to a horse-drawn cart spraying some sort of liquid on the path as it moves along. Lettering on the back of the cart reads "Bradford City Council no. 30" (00.58). Cut to wide steps, with a number of smartly dressed men walking down them (presumably entering the show) (01.14). Cut to a shot of the blades of a windmill as they turn (01.23). Cut to a general shot of the show, with crowds and various stalls (02.07). A marquee in the background has the sign "R. Hornsby & Sons Ltd., Grantham". Another sign reads "Marshall. Sons & Co.". Chimneys and houses can be seen in the background (02.27min).

The content description can be based on a viewing of the work, accompanying documentation, or secondary sources, but the source should be clearly noted.

For unedited Works, where time and resources permit, each scene should be summarized. If there are shots of particular significance or interest – of, for example, prominent people or places – these should be recorded. Otherwise a general description of scenes and sequences will suffice⁵¹.

If applicable, add information about the content of the moving image Variant where it differs from the content of the Work.

2.4.6.1 Content Description Type

Include a qualifying keyword or otherwise denote the type of summary (e.g. Synopsis, Shotlist, Review).⁵²

2.4.7 Notes

Notes for moving image Works/Variants are annotations providing additional information or clarification relating specifically to Works/Variants attributes and relationships.⁵³ See [Appendix B, Cataloguer's Notes](#).

2.4.8 History

Record historical information about events of interest in the creation of the original moving image Work/Variant that is of value for your users, such as censorship history, production versions, and the like. This historical information may be recorded in association with instances of Events or Agents.

If desired, institutions may include historical information that crosses over into being about the Manifestation(s) and/or Item(s). This may be done where there is value to the user in keeping all the information together for research or clarification purposes rather than across disparate Manifestation and Item records. This may also be applied where no History fields exist in an institution's system at Manifestation or Item levels, or a no hierarchy one level structure is used.

Example⁵⁴:

⁵¹Irish Film Archive, p. 23.

⁵²EN 15907, 6.17.3 Elements, Description type, p. 30.

⁵³Based on RDA 2.20.1.Basic Instructions on Making Notes on Manifestations or Items

⁵⁴Abridged version of fuller Work History note from BFI CID record for the film

Christopher Columbus (United Kingdom, 1949, David MacDonald)

There are three documented versions. Version one: which has the shortened reels 3A and 3B; Version two: which has the shorter ending; Version three: which has the long ending (this script is based on the full length reels 3A and 3B and on the short ending, as this is the export version. The short ending (version two) has Columbus reinstated by the King and Queen, him leaving their presence and telling Juana he will be remembered longer than the monarchs as he walks down a corridor. The longer version (version three) has a more American feel with two sailors informing Columbus of the great nation his discovery will give rise to, complete with quotes from Jefferson, Lincoln and Roosevelt.

2.4.8.1 Custodial History

If desired, write a brief custodial history of the Work/Variant if known, particularly for rare and unique materials. Indicate the current holding institution of the original or master material if known.

Information on the provenance of the specific Items in an archive's collection should be included in the Item sections.

2.4.8.2 Censorship History

Document information related to the censorship history of a Work/Variant, including:⁵⁵

- any events in which a Manifestation/Item of a Work/Variant was evaluated by a censorship body or an accredited rating agency
- the geographic region for which the verdict is (was) valid
- any identifier issued by the agency uniquely identifying the act of rating or censorship and associated documents such as censorship visa or rating certificates
- the outcome of the act of rating or censorship

Example⁵⁶:

À bout de souffle (France, 1960, Jean-Luc Godard)

In Italy, this film has three different theatrical distributions, corresponding to three different visas ("visto di censura") from the official censorship body (Ufficio di revisione cinematografica).

Censored Variant: Theatrical distribution in Italy – censorship visa n. 32329 – date: 1960-07-05 – Length 2463m – original French – not for under 16 years

Dubbed, Censored Variant: Theatrical distribution in Italy – censorship visa n. 57609 – date: 1971-01-23 – Length 2440m. – Italian

Dubbed, Censored Variant: Theatrical distribution in Italy – censorship visa n. 64662 – date: 1974-05-20 – Length 2430m. – Italian dubbed

2.4.8.3 Other Work/Variant History

Any other relevant information or clarifications pertaining to the Work/Variant. For example:

- any changes of director, crew, or cast part-way through production

⁵⁵EN 15907, 6.13 Decision event, pp. 26-27.

⁵⁶http://www.italiataglia.it/tagli_rassegna/bout_de_souffle

Example:

Tosca (Italy, 1939, Karl Koch) The film was started by Jean Renoir, but after beginning, Renoir escaped to France because of World War II. The film was completed by his assistant Karl Koch, with Luchino Visconti as assistant.

- any demise of members of the cast or crew associated with the production

Example:

Foolish Wives (United States of America, 1922, Erich von Stroheim) Actor Rudolph Christians died in mid-shooting; replaced by Robert Edenson who is used mainly as a double.

- explanations regarding length of time between production and release, e.g., due to funding issues, an initial banning, delayed release due to sensitivity over subject matter and world events, etc.

Examples:

La porta del cielo (Italy, 1945, Vittorio De Sica) The shooting of the film lasted almost one year (February – November 1944) throughout the period of Nazi occupation of Rome and served as an excuse to hide and protect Jewish people, anti-fascists, etc...

La grande illusion (France, 1937, Jean Renoir) The shooting of the film lasted two years (1935-1936) and the first projection was in 1937.

- any other information relevant to the history of the Work and its production

Example⁵⁷:

Christopher Columbus (United Kingdom, 1949, David MacDonald) Location shooting in Barbados was fraught with difficulties. The re-created ship stuck on launch, was then later rammed, suffered mechanical failure and finally caught fire. The stand-in ship was then lost at sea twice. Location shooting was hampered by the heat and the local gaol had to be used to keep the Technicolor film cool. There was also a troublesome parrot that would shout "tea break" during a dramatic scene.

2.5 Relationships of a Work/Variant (links/associations with other entities/records)

A relationship associates an instance of a Work/Variant with another instance of an entity. Entities are described in subsequent sections, but examples of entities are people or companies associated with a Work/Variant (eg, studio, director, cast), events (copyright registration), subjects (other Works/Variants are about the same subject), and records.

Relationships can be implemented in many ways, depending on the purpose, the modelling paradigm, or architectural constraints of the chosen platform. These guidelines are intended to be data structure neutral.⁵⁸ Therefore, these guidelines cannot prescribe exactly how to demonstrate relationships. Instead they recommend that certain relationships be established without instruction on how precisely those links be made manifest, i.e., whether by physical associative record linking or "see also" text conventions.

A Work may have relationships with the following:

⁵⁷ Abridged version of fuller Work History note from BFI CID record for the film.

⁵⁸ EN 15907 8.1 Relationships. General

- Agent(s)
- Event(s)
- Subject(s)/Genre(s)/Form(s)
- Variant(s)
- Manifestation(s)
- Other (including other Works)

A Variant may have relationships with the following:

- Agent(s)
- Event(s)
- Subject(s)/Genre(s)/Form(s)
- Work(s)
- Manifestation(s)
- Other (including other Variants)

2.5.1 Agents (e.g. Cast, Credits, Person, Organisation, etc.)

An Agent is defined as an entity that is involved in the creation, realisation, curation or exploitation of a Work/Variant and who is considered to have major responsibility for, or be of major importance to, the Work/Variant. Typical distinctions between Agent types are Person, Corporate Body, Family and Person Group.⁵⁹ This includes cast and credits for the Work/Variant.

Agent(s) may also have relationships to an instance of a specific Event or of an “Other” relationship in connection with the Work/Variant.

Because responsibility for moving image materials is most often complex and highly diverse, institutions - particularly those with special interests - should determine the types of activities they wish to include. These activities may vary from institution to institution according to the types of moving image material held. For example, an institution holding primarily television material may consider the activity of producer more important than that of director. Institutions whose collections are primarily composed of motion picture material may value equally the activities of directors and producers. Provide access to Agents when they have made an important contribution to the particular Work or Variant, even when the type of responsibility (credit function) is one that may not be considered major in other Works/Variants or types of Works/Variants.⁶⁰

Agents may be described in two ways: as discrete index points, and/or merged into one field where the credits are listed in order of role importance or as transcribed from the Work.

Optionally, record multiple instances of Agent, e.g., cast and credits, associated with aggregated Works/Variants (See [E.6 Credits \(i.e. Agents\) for Aggregates](#)).

For recording the attributes of Agents (e.g. first name, last name, nationality, etc.), refer to authoritative sources such as AACR2, applicable RDA chapters for recording attributes of Persons, Families, and Corporate Bodies or tools such as the Virtual International Authority File (VIAF) (viaf.org), Library of Congress Name Authority File (authorities.loc.gov), Library of Congress Linked Data Service (id.loc.gov), Getty Union List of Artists Names (ULAN), International Standard Name Identifier (ISNI).

It is also recommended where possible to register key Agents with any of the aforementioned authority bodies if they are not already included.

Optionally, if the Agent is credited under a name that is not identical with the preferred name from an authority file, record the name as used in the current instance of the related entity.

Examples:

Bob Robertson (pseudonym/screen name used by the director Sergio Leone at the beginning of the career)

⁵⁹EN 15907, 5.1 Agent

⁶⁰1991 FIAF Cataloguing Rules for Film Archives – Statements of Responsibility, p. 35.

Terence Hill (pseudonym/screen name used by the actor Mario Girotti in the most known part of his career)

Sofia Lazzaro (first pseudonym/screen name used by the actress Sophia Loren, whose birth name is Sofia Villani Scicolone).

2.5.1.1 Agents Activity

This describes the activity or role of the Agent in relation to the moving image Work/Variant (e.g. credit terms).

Record one or more Agent Activity terms, for example, “animator,” “cast,” “choreographer,” etc., to express the nature of the agent’s relationship to the Work or Variant. Choose the single most specific term, if possible. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms, such as the [FIAF Glossary of Filmographic Terms](#)⁶¹.

If no suggested terms apply, compose a term to describe the relationship between the Agent and the Work/Variant being catalogued. If the relationship is ambiguous, use a value to indicate this, for example, “unknown” or “on-screen participant” to indicate a person appearing on screen in a capacity that is indeterminate or not covered by typical terms.⁶² Optionally, when the role performed by an Agent is probable but not certain, provide the function name followed by a question mark.

Besides the principal Agent Activity suggested, institutions, particularly those with special interests, should create and apply in-house value lists of other specific Agent Types, which may vary from institution to institution.

Record in a note any additional details that cannot be expressed through controlled terms. (e.g. “appears only in final scene”, etc.). If a name is known to be fictitious, or requires clarification, make a note giving the actual name.

Give the Agent(s) and Agent Activity in the terms and language in which they appear, either in the sources of information or in the language of the institution, or both. If more than one Agent is associated with a particular role connected with a Work/Variant or Event, where possible or desirable, record the names in the order indicated by the sequence, layout, or typography of the names on the source of information. Preserving the ordering of the credited persons should be determined by the requirements of individual institutions.⁶³

Examples:

Les Enfants du paradis
réalisation, Marcel Carné
scénario et dialogue, Jacques Prévert
musique, Maurice Thiriet

OR

Enfants du paradis, Les
director, Marcel Carné
script and dialogue, Jacques Prévert
music, Maurice Thiriet

⁶¹<http://www.fiafnet.org/publications/GlossaryMasterComboMarch2015.html.htm>

⁶²List of relator terms are a combination of those found in YCR, 1.3.2. Other creators, pp. 42-43; and, OLAC TF, Part II, Core Attributes and Relationships, Commonly-Occurring Roles, pp. 16-18.

⁶³FIAF, 1.6.2, pp. 36-37.

Star wars
Director, George Lucas
Executive Producer, George Lucas
Producer, Gary Kurtz
Screenplay, George Lucas

If Agents are added as index points rather than listed or described in order of importance, an organisation may choose to put the Agent Activity or role term(s) at the end of the name.

Examples:

Les Enfants du paradis
Carné, Marcel, réalisation
Prevert, Jacques, scénario, dialogue
Thiriet, Maurice, musique

Star wars
Lucas, George, director, executive producer, screenplay
Kurtz, Gary, producer

2.5.2 Events (e.g., IPR registration, screenings, awards, etc.) ⁶⁴

An Event characterises occurrences in the lifecycle of a moving image Work or its Variants. Instances of any Event type can have Agent and “Other” relationships.

Record one or more Event type, for example, “publication,” “copyright/IPR registration,” “festival showing,” etc., to express the nature of the Event’s relationship to the Work/Variant. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.4 Event Types](#).

2.5.3 Subject/Genre/Form Terms

Provide access to the Work by means of subjects (or subject identifiers) that describe the content of the Work (i.e., what the Work is about). Use an existing data value standard such as Library of Congress Subject Headings (LCSH).⁶⁵ Alternatively, or additionally, use standards such as Universal Decimal Classification (UDC), Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC), or equivalent in country in which you are working, or an in-house data value standard.

In addition, access to the Work can be provided by means of genre(s) and/or form(s) (or identifiers) of which the Work is an example (i.e., what the Work is). Form describes the format and/or purpose of a Work, e.g., “non-fiction,” “short” and “animation” are particular forms or identifiers. Genre describes categories of Works, characterized by similar plots, themes, settings, situations, and characters. Examples of genres are “westerns” and “thrillers”.⁶⁶ Use an existing and widely used data value standard such as Library of Congress Thesaurus for Genre/Form Terms in Libraries and Archives (LCGFT)⁶⁷, or equivalent in country where work is being done, or an in-house controlled vocabulary genre thesaurus.

TODO this is an example table

Examples:

Main title A trip down Market Street before the fire / [Miles Brothers]. ⁶⁸

⁶⁴EN 15907 5.2 Event

⁶⁵Adapted from YCR, 1.3.3. Subjects, pp. 43-45

⁶⁶Frequently Asked Questions about Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms for Library and Archival Materials (LCGFT), Revised June 6, 2011, http://www.loc.gov/catdir/cpsd/genre_form_faq.pdf

⁶⁷<http://id.loc.gov/authorities/genreForms>

⁶⁸For full record see <http://lccn.loc.gov/00694408>

Published/Created United States. [United States : Miles Brothers, 1906].

Summary The following is a scene-by-scene description of the film: [Frame: 0300 (part 1)] The film begins looking northeast on Market Street just west of the intersection of Hyde, Grove and 8th streets. The dark building at right is the Odd Fellows Hall and the grey building beyond (across 8th St.) is the Grant Building (1905). A white postal service automobile is at left center. The three large buildings receding down Market Street at left are [0319 (part 1)] the Murphy Building (1889), [0353 (part 1)] the Donohoe Building (1890), and the Flood Building (1905). [etc.; this is an excerpt from the full record.]

Subjects Market Street (San Francisco, Calif.) Street-railroads-California-San Francisco. Horse-drawn vehicles-California-San Francisco. City traffic-California-San Francisco. Pedestrians-California-San Francisco. Automobiles-California-San Francisco.

Form/Genre Actualities (Motion pictures) Short films. Silent films. Nonfiction films.

Main title Mardi Gras parade – US : Thomas A. Edison, Inc. [producer, distributor], [190-?].

Summary Early actuality footage, shot from a single location on a street in New Orleans, showing a Mardi Gras parade. Mule drawn floats, children and adults in costumes, and brass bands march down the street, as crowds of spectators mill about the sidewalks, sometimes spilling into the street.

Subjects 1. Carnival – Louisiana – New Orleans. 2. Parades – Louisiana – New Orleans. 3. Holidays.

Genres 1. Actualities. 2. Shorts.

Main title British Canadian Pathe news. No. 83A / L.E. Ouimet presents. – CA : British Canadian Pathe News [producer], 1919 ; CA : Specialty Film Ltd. [distributor], 1919.

Contents London: Ilford Municipal Market proves great success (43 ft.) – Yarmouth, Eng.: Happy hours by the sea (46 ft.) – Lauzon, Que.: World's largest drydock (84 ft.) – Toronto: Cycle racing at Exhibition Park (218 ft.) – Kingston: [Geo. Vernot, Canadian swimmer, demonstrates strokes] (140 ft.) – Fresno, Cal.: [Staged train wreck at fair] (69 ft.) – Gary, Ind.: [Federal troops in big steel centers as result of recent riots] (150 ft.) – Getting together, an animated cartoon by Bert Green (65 ft.) – A Review of events in Great Britain: Yarmouth: Deutschland, German Navy ship, now tourist attraction; London: "Pussy-foot" Johnson trying to make Britain "dry;" Doncaster: horse racing; Manchester: statue of Abraham Lincoln unveiled, gift of the U.S. to England's great Cotton City (123 ft.).

Subjects 1. Markets – England – London. 2. London (England) – Description. 3. Seaside resorts – England. 4. Yarmouth (Isle of Wight) – Description. 5. Drydocks – Canada. 6. Saint Henri (Quebec) – Description. 7. Bicycle racing – Canada. 8. Swimming – Canada. 9. Strikes and lockouts – Steel industry – United States. 10. Prohibition – England. 11. Horse-racing – England. 12. Doncaster (South Yorkshire) – Description. 13. Lincoln, Abraham, 1809-1865 – Statues. 14. Manchester (Greater Manchester) – Description.

Genre 1. Newsreels.

Main title O Beijo da mulher aranha = Kiss of the spider woman / director, Hector Babenco ; producer, David Weisman ; screenplay, Leonard Schrader. – BR : HB Filmes [producer], 1985 ; US Sugarloaf Films [producer], 1985 ; US : Island Alive [distributor], 1985.

Summary Molina, a homosexual window-trimmer convicted on a morals charge, shares a dreary prison cell with Valentin, a clandestinely-held politically active journalist who has been endlessly tortured by prison authorities in a vain attempt to extract information about his activities. Both men could not be farther apart in personal attitudes, lifestyles, and emotional makeup: Molina is a glib raconteur, who dwells in a fantasy world of glamorous movies from yesteryear, of romantic screen heroes and tragic heroines. Valentin is a self-disciplined intellectual who is devoted to the cause of human rights and his political concerns. [etc. ; this is an excerpt from the full record]

Subjects 1. Prisoners – Drama. 2. Interpersonal relations – Drama. 3. Homosexuality, Male – Drama. 4. Political prisoners – Drama. 5. Torture – Drama.

Genres 1. Drama. 2. Features.

2.5.4 Other relationships ⁶⁹

If desired or appropriate, express relationships that are not covered by the Agent, Subject, and Event relationships, including all kinds of aggregation and re-use of Works and their Variants. (See [Appendix E, Aggregates](#).)

Commonly-occurring relationships include:⁷⁰

- Work(s) that the moving image Work is based on (e.g. moving images adapted from novels, plays, etc.)

Example:

The grapes of wrath (United States of America, 1940, John Ford), based on the homonymous novel by John Steinbeck (1939).

- Work(s) that the moving image Work is a performance of (moving image recordings made of live stage presentations of music, plays, dance, etc.)

Example:

Pink Floyd: live at Pompeii (Belgium, West Germany, France, 1972, Adrian Maben), concert filmed in the old Pompeii amphitheatre.

- Work(s) that the moving image Work forms part of (e.g. series/serials, aggregations/compilations)

Examples:

Fantômas contre Fantômas (Serial in 5 episodes, Louis Feuillade 1914, production Société des Etablissements Gaumont).

Fiddlesticks, Ub Iwerks, 1930, episode of the animation series Flip the Frog (Celebrity Pictures, distr. Metro Goldwyn-Mayer, 1930-1933 (38 issues)).

- Work(s) that the moving image Work has a sequential relationship with (e.g. sequels, prequels, serials)

Example:

The Godfather Part I
The Godfather Part II
The Godfather Part III Francis Ford Coppola (United States of America, 1972- 1974-1990)

- Work(s) about the moving image Work (e.g. documentary about the making of a feature film or TV programme)

Examples:

La ciociara quarant'anni dopo (Italy, 2001, Stefano Landini), documentary on the restoration of La ciociara (Italy, 1960, Vittorio De Sica).

⁶⁹ EN 15907 8.5 HasAsSubject; YCR, 1.2.7 Relationships With Other Moving Image Works or Other Kinds of Works

⁷⁰ OLAC TF, Part I, Moving Image Work Definition and Boundaries, Commonly-Occurring Relationships, p. 16.

Reise nach Metropoli (Germany, 2009, Artem Demenok), documentary on the restoration of Metropolis (Fritz Lang, 1927).

- Work(s) that are promotional material of the moving image Work (e.g. Trailers)

Example:

Wuthering Heights (Film Trailer) (United States of America, 1939) is the trailer for Wuthering Heights (United States of America, 1939, William Wyler)

- Non-moving image Works that the moving image Work has a relationship with (e.g. Books, articles, scripts, posters, documents, etc)

Examples:

Kes (United Kingdom, 1969, Ken Loach), book "Life after Kes: an anthology of the film Kes", by Simon W. Golding. GET Publishing, 2005. ISBN. 0954879333

Land and freedom (United Kingdom, 1995, Ken Loach), script Land and freedom (c.1993) (script for 'Land and freedom', with opening sequence different from earlier scripts).

Carry on camping (United Kingdom, 1969, Gerald Thomas), archival documents - general production correspondence including notes from the pre-production meeting, studio agreement, final screen credits, and draft trailer script).

The wicked lady (United Kingdom, 1945, Leslie Arliss), costume

Record one or more "Other" relationship type terms to express the nature of the relationship to the Work/Variant, choosing the most specific term possible from a controlled list of values, for example, "based on," "contained in," etc. . A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [Appendix D.17.1 Work/Variant Other Relationship Types](#).

Or, compose a term to describe the relationship between the Work being catalogued and the related Work.

In a note, add any additional information concerning the relationship considered relevant.

Describe or demonstrate Work-to-Work relationships through linking to the Work identifier of the related Work, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of the institution's data structure.

Remember, a Work based on a pre-existing Work should be identified as a Variant of the same Work unless it has been so significantly changed as to have become a new related Work.⁷¹ See [1.1.1 Boundaries between Works](#) and [1.1.2 Boundaries between Works and Variants/Manifestations](#) for determining when a Work should be identified as a new, but related Work and when it should be identified as a Variant of the original Work.

2.5.5 Variants

Express the relationship between a moving image Work and a moving image Variant (e.g., Part/part of). Describe or demonstrate Work-to-Variant relationships through linking to the Work identifier, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of your data structure.

⁷¹YCR, 1.1.7 Works based on previous works, pp. 24-25.

2.5.6 Manifestations

Express the relationship between a moving image Work or Variant and a moving image Manifestation (e.g., Part/part of). Describe or demonstrate Work-to-Manifestation relationships through linking to the Work identifier, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of your data structure.

3 Moving Image Variants

3.1 Definitions⁷²

Brief definitions of the standard CEN terms Work/Variant/Manifestation/Item used in the Manual were provided at the end of the Introduction (see [Introduction](#)). This and the following sections provide in-depth definitions of the terms as used in these guidelines, beginning with the highest level in the description hierarchy: Moving Image Works and Variants.

3.1.1 Moving Image Variant⁷³

A moving image Variant is an entity that may be used to indicate any change to content-related characteristics that do not significantly change the overall content of a Work as a whole. Such Variants can be produced by minor additions, deletions or substitutions to the content. As a general guideline, changes that would result in a different content description should be treated as a separate Work rather than a Variant.

Changes that could be described as Variants are detailed below, in [1.1.2 Boundaries between Moving Image Works and Variants](#), and may include the addition of subtitles, dubbing, and editing as a result of censorship or adjustment of duration, e.g. for TV programming. For institutions that have made a policy decision not to use the Variant, these changes may constitute Manifestation differences.

The determination of a Variant requires human analysis, and as such is an interpretative practice. It is not always easy to establish what the Variants may be. For example, an institution may have a television recording of a motion picture broadcast but no way of comparing it with an original theatrical copy as to whether it has been altered in terms of subtle censorship of content or duration

Therefore, this entity is optional. If employed, each instance of a Variant is related to a Work and can have one-to-many relationships with instances of Manifestation(s), and many-to-many relationships with Event(s), Agent(s) and Other Relation(s). If no Variant of a Work exists or is known to exist, then this entity can be omitted, connecting an instance of a Work with one or more instances of Manifestation.

⁷²For a discussion of other definitions of the “Work” and Variant entities, see [Moving Image Works](#).

⁷³Adapted from EN 15907, 4.2 Variant.

4 3. Moving Image Manifestations

3.0 Definition

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3.4.1 Agent(s)

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3.4.3 "Other" relationships

3.4.4 Item(s)

3.4.5 Work

3.4.6 Variant

4.1 3.0 Definition

A moving image Manifestation is the embodiment of a moving image Work/Variant. Manifestations usually include all analogue, digital and online media associated with a particular embodiment of a Work/Variant.

A Manifestation possesses common characteristics with respect to shared intellectual content and physical format, e.g., releases, broadcasts, etc.

It may be whole or incomplete or a fragment.

A Manifestation is not exclusively bound to a single Work/Variant, since it can be an aggregate for reasons connected to the publication, to the commercial release, or for mere convenience. A Manifestation can therefore be associated or linked to more than one Work/Variant, where an institution's system allows.

For Aggregate Manifestations see [Appendix E, Aggregates](#).

4.2 3.1 Boundaries between Manifestations

The boundaries between one Manifestation and another are drawn on the basis of two criteria: changes in the publication context and changes in format.⁷⁴ The distinction between one Manifestation and another can be made according to one of the two criteria or the presence of both.

If the embodiment of a Work/Variant involves contextual changes, related to the publication or release process, the resulting product is a new Manifestation, e.g., a change from theatrical release to home video distribution; a change of release country and different dubbed/subtitled language; a change of broadcast company/streaming platform; a re-release or repeat broadcast on a different date, etc.

In this case, create a new Manifestation and characterise it according to a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found at [D.5 Manifestation Types](#)

4.4 3.1.2 Changes in the format

If the embodiment of a Work/Variant involves changes in format, the resulting product is a new Manifestation, e.g., a change from 70mm to 35mm.

Create a new Manifestation when there is evidence of at least one (or more than one) of the following changes from the original format:

- Changes to the physical format or the digital file on which it is fixed;
- Changes to the display characteristics (i.e. in aspect ratio, sound or colour characteristics, etc.);
- Change in the container (i.e. cassette to cartridge as container for a tape).

Include and describe any of the distinguishing physical changes according to the guidelines in [2.3.4 Format](#).

The example below shows a number of possible Manifestations of the original Italian version of *Il gattopardo* (Italy, France, Luchino Visconti, 1963).

Example of change in format:

⁷⁴The definitions that individuate a "new" M. I. Manifestation and distinguish one from another are mainly based on YEE 2008 (draft), 81.

4.3 3.1.1 Changes in the publication context

Il gattopardo (Italy, France, Luchino Visconti, 1963)
Theatrical release, 35mm, Cinemascope – aspect ratio 2,35 : 1
Theatrical release, 70mm, Cinemascope – aspect ratio 2,20 : 1

Example of change in format and publication context:

Il gattopardo (Luchino Visconti, 1963)
Home video publication, DVD – aspect ratio 2,21 :1 – Medusa Video, Italia, 00/00/2009

In-house copying of an institution's holding onto a different format, e.g. a video transfer of a 35mm film does not necessitate creation of a new Manifestation. In this case there is also the option of simply creating an Item for the copy, and linking it to the same Manifestation as the source Item.

This option depends on an institution's policy. Some may choose always to create a new Manifestation (i.e. a Preservation Manifestation) in such cases, whilst others may decide to create a new Manifestation where change in format and change in distribution/publication coincide but simply create a new Item linked to an existing Manifestation where change in format is as a result of in-house copying.

It is for an institution to decide on which approach it prefers and apply consistently.

4.5 3.2 Attributes of a Manifestation

4.6 3.2.1 Manifestation Type

As previously mentioned, a Manifestation is defined on the basis of two criteria: changes in the publication context and changes in format. The element Manifestation Type describes the specific type of change.

The Manifestation Type is expressed by a phrase denoting the relationship between the Manifestation and the associated Work/Variant, for example, "pre-release," "theatrical distribution," "not for release," "original," etc.

Record the Manifestation Type by taking the most suitable term from a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.5 Manifestation Types](#).

If it is impossible to determine the specific Manifestation Type the information can be omitted or indicated by a value of "unknown."

Statements made about Language, Format and/or Extent may have an added value of "original" to indicate characteristics of an "original Work," where such a concept is required or desired.⁷⁵ Associating the value of "original" with a particular Manifestation indicates it has privileged status in relation to other possible Manifestations.

4.7 3.3 Elements of a Manifestation

4.8 3.3.1 Identifier

Create an unambiguous reference to the Manifestation, such as a specific standard number issued by an official body (i.e. V-ISAN⁷⁶ or DOI⁷⁷), or a system-automated assigned ID number. These should be different identifiers than those for Works/Variants, since they are for specific embodiments of the Work/Variant.

⁷⁵The indication of "original" values at the Manifestation level follows EN 15907 attributes of a Manifestation, pp. 10-11.

⁷⁶The V-ISAN represents the third segment of the ISAN number, which consists of a 96-bits number structured as follows: the first is the root, which identifies the work, the second is the episode section, which identifies the part within a multi-part work, the third is the so-called version section, which identifies variants and Manifestations (particularly as far as format changes and "media embodiments", such as Blu-Ray, digital files, tapes, etc., are concerned): see http://www.isan.org/docs/isan_user_guide.pdf, Version 2.2.2. February 2012, 13/49.

⁷⁷DOI (= Digital Object Identifier): see <http://www.doi.org/>.

If one or more identifiers are available, record each according to its standardised syntax, where allowable. The following examples reflect both 3 and 4 level hierarchies, i.e. ones that use Variants and ones that do not have Variants but utilise Manifestations instead.

Examples:

Lola rennt (Germany, 1998, Tom Tykwer)
Work identifier: ISAN 0000-0000-606A-0000-0-0000-0000-3
Variant identifier (original German): ISAN 0000-0000-606A-0000-0-0000-0002-0
Manifestation identifier: Home video publication (2007) – Run Lola Run – DVD – English – V-ISAN: ISAN 0000-0000-606A-0000-0-0000-0001-1 (DVD-31943)

Shichinin no samurai (Japan, 1954, Akira Kurosawa)
Work identifier: ISAN 0000-0001-61AE-0000-1-0000-0001-W
Variant identifier (Dubbed Spanish – Castellano): Los Siete Samurai: ISAN 0000-0001-61AE-0000-1-0000-0001-W

Les chevaliers du ciel (France, 2005, Gérard Pirès)
Manifestation identifier: Home video publication – DVD – Fox Pathé Europa (publisher) – 2006 – ISAN 0000-0001-8CFA-0000-I-0000-000-

8 1/2 (Italy, 1962, Federico Fellini) Otto e mezzo – Alternative title of the Work
Work identifier: ISAN 0000-0000-161F-0000-W-0000-0000-F
Manifestation identifier: V- ISAN 0000-0000-161F-0000-W-0000-0002-B – Italian (spoken); Japanese (subtitles) – DVD – Blu-ray – 2013/01/11 – Japan)

4.9 3.3.1.1 Identifier Type

If an institution's system allows, as with the Work/Variant Identifiers a "Type" can be applied with an Identifier to define the source of the Identifier.

4.10 3.3.2 Title

Record at least one title, identifying phrase, or name for the Manifestation Title. This is a transcribed element, reflecting the actual title as it appears on screen. The original release title would be added under the Work/Variant Title field.

If multiple titles are recorded, where allowable, associate a "Title Type" to a title for differentiation between the various types of titles (see [2.3.2.1 Title Type](#) and [A.2 Title Types](#)).

The title of a Manifestation can sometimes differ, either slightly or wholly from the title of the Variant or Work to which it is linked. This may be the case, for example, with the acquisition of an incomplete Manifestation lacking a title or with a title added by the source of the acquisition.

See [Appendix A.1 Title](#) for further titling details and information.

For creating titles for untitled or unidentified entities see [A.2.5 Supplied/Devised Titles](#)

See [Appendix E.4](#) for titling of Aggregates.

For guidance on wording, order, spelling, punctuation, accentuation and capitalisation, see [Chapter 0. Preliminary Notes](#).

For sources of information for the Manifestation Title, see [Section 0.3 Sources of Information](#).

4.11 3.3.2.1 Title Type

Where relevant for an institution, if the Manifestation includes multiple titles, such as a title in another language for a dubbed or subtitled variant, record the relevant titles and associate a "Title Type" to each title for differentiation between the various types of titles (see [Appendix A, Titles and Title Types](#)).

4.12 3.3.3 Language

"Language" should ideally be presented as a set of two elements: the language term, and its usage in a particular Manifestation. Language can be present in a Manifestation as written, spoken or sung. Its usage qualifies whether the specific language is dialogue, dubbed, subtitles, intertitles, etc.

4.13 3.3.3.1 Language terms

Where possible, record the language(s) using the full form of name, e.g., French, Italian, etc. rather than abbreviations or codes, by taking the most suitable value(s) from a controlled list. This can be an in-house list but it is preferable to use a standard language list such as ISO 639 (http://www.loc.gov/standards/iso639-2/php/code_list.php).

Optionally, record the language code as found in ISO 639.

If no language can be determined, the information can be omitted or indicated by a value of "not known".

4.14 3.3.3.2 Usage type

More than one language can occur in different forms, depending on how the content is expressed: the usage type of the languages defines the form with which the language is expressed, for example, spoken, sung, written, etc.

Record the usage type of a language by taking the most suitable value from a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.6 Manifestation Language Usage Types](#).

If usage type(s) cannot be determined, indicate a value of "unknown".

Examples:

Caccia tragica (Italy, Giuseppe De Santis, 1947)
Not for release (archival) – 35mm – Italian (spoken), Romanian (intertitles)

New York stories, (United States of America, Woody Allen, Francis Ford Coppola, Martin Scorsese, 1989)
Home video publication – DVD, English (spoken); – Italian, German; English, Italian, German, French, Spanish (subtitles) – Buena Vista (publisher), 2002/05/16

The Bridge. Episode 1 (Sweden, Denmark, Charlotte Sieling, 2011)
TV broadcast – United Kingdom, 2012-04-21 – Swedish (Dialogue (original)), Danish (Dialogue (original)), English (Subtitles)

4.15 3.3.4 Format of a moving image Manifestation

As previously mentioned, a Manifestation is defined on the basis of two criteria: changes in the publication context and changes in format. The format of a Manifestation is the description of the physical artefact or the digital file on which it is fixed. The concept of format as applied to Manifestations is the "ideal" representation of all the physical items or computer files that

bear the same characteristics and descend from a common Work/Variant, regardless of what is actually held in a collection.

A majority of the physical and digital description elements of moving image Manifestations are intended to be inherited by the Items, as they serve as the exemplars of Manifestations. In some databases, selection of a physical carrier type initiates provision of element fields relevant to that type at a Manifestation level, or an Item level, or both (e.g. in a 2-Level hierarchy. See “Shallow hierarchy model: 2 levels” found at [0.2.1 Elements of description across Works, Variants, Manifestations, and Items](#)).

Ideally the information need only be recorded once irrespective of where in the data structure an institution must place it. Therefore guidelines for the treatment of high-level physical and digital description elements are explained fully in the Manifestation chapter. The Item chapter contains a detailed listing of item-specific elements. Physical properties such as Extent and Format at the Manifestation level represent the “ideal,” and item-specific elements will capture where it differs from this “ideal” at the Item level.

The information about the format of a Manifestation plays a relevant role because any change in format represents a criterion to determine the boundaries between one Manifestation and another (see [2.1 Boundaries between Manifestations](#)).

Record a new Manifestation of a Work/Variant when there is evidence of at least one, or more than one, of the following changes associated with the format:

- Changes to the physical artefact or the digital file on which it is fixed
- Changes to the display characteristics (i.e. in aspect ratio, sound or colour characteristics, etc.)
- Change in the container (i.e. cassette to cartridge as container for a tape).

In a note (See [Appendix B, Cataloguer’s Notes](#)), explain the format changes used to determine the Manifestation in hand as different and “new” in comparison with any other, already identified and described Manifestation.

The description of the format of a Manifestation is articulated in the following elements:

- Carrier type
- Projection characteristics
- Sound characteristics
- Colour characteristics

4.16 3.3.4.1 Carrier type of a Manifestation

Carrier type is the medium on or the encoding format in which the Manifestation is fixed.

Its description consists of a general carrier type, which describes the basic properties of the Manifestation’s physical format, for example, film, video tape, digital file, etc., and a specific carrier type, which corresponds to the gauge, in case of films and tapes, and for digital files, to the physical carrier on which the file is stored.

4.17 3.3.4.1.1 General Carrier Type

The broad media type of the Manifestation (e.g., film, video, audio, optical, digital file). Recording this high-level information will enable simple searching for only film, video, digital, etc. elements rather than searching by all possible formats and carriers.

A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.2 Manifestation/Item Specific Carrier Type](#).

For reasons of clarity and to avoid redundancy, optionally, institutions can decide to skip the general carrier type description, since it is already implicit in the specific carrier type.

4.18 3.3.4.1.2 Specific Carrier Type

Record the specific carrier type, by indicating

1. For film and video: the width of the film stock or of the magnetic tape on which the Manifestation is fixed;
2. For digital files: The physical carrier storing the digital file.

For digital files, it is most important for users to immediately identify the file container or wrapper (MXF, MOV, DPX, etc.) rather than the physical media on which it is stored. Physical media storing a file can change, but that does not necessarily mean that the file format has changed. For purposes of distinguishing the format change that constitutes a new Manifestation, it is the digital file format that is the important distinguishing factor. Information on the specific codecs and resolution are captured in Item elements.

For optical media, only add commercially produced media here. If the optical media is “writable” and is being used to store a digital file, put the digital file format in the general carrier type, and the optical storage media in specific media type.

Select the value from a suitable controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.2 Manifestation/Item Specific Carrier Type](#).

4.19 3.3.4.2 Projection characteristics of a Manifestation

The projection characteristics of a Manifestation include aspect ratio and aperture or image format.

Aspect Ratio

The aspect ratio (also known as projection ratio) is the projected image area visible on screen, expressed as a value of width to height (the value of height always being “1”), for example, 2.34:1, 2.39:1. Selection should be made from a controlled list of values. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.14 Aspect Ratio](#).

The aspect ratio reflects the compositional intentions of the original content makers and the intended presentation of the moving image content.⁷⁸ If the aspect ratio of a Work/Variant is altered, moving image information is lost, creating a Manifestation/Item with different moving image content.⁷⁹ The Manifestation should reflect the projected image of the Work/Variant that it represents, rather than that on the Item. Institutions may record variations in projection characteristics as Item-specifics, rather than create multiple Manifestations.

Aperture/Image Format

The actual exposed image or picture area as it appears on the moving image itself, for example Academy, Full screen, Widescreen, etc. The image format does not necessarily bear any relation to the preferred projection ratio (aspect ratio) of the moving image.⁸⁰

Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.15 Aperture](#).

Sound characteristics are technical specifications relating to the placement of sound on a Manifestation.⁸¹

Its description consists of a statement about the presence or absence of sound, and optionally, in case of presence, of the description of the method with which the sound has been fixed.

Indicate the presence or absence of sound in the Manifestation, i.e. “sound,” “silent,” “mute”. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.4 Manifestation/Item Sound Type](#).

⁷⁸This definition from Academy Film Archive in-house glossary of terms, and OLAC, Moving Image Works, Part 3a: Operational Definitions (08/09) (PDF Document), http://olacinc.org/drupal/capc_files/MIW_3a.pdf.

⁷⁹OLAC, Moving Image Works, Part 3a: Operational Definitions (08/09) (PDF Document), http://olacinc.org/drupal/capc_files/MIW_3a.pdf

⁸⁰This definition from Academy Film Archive in-house glossary of terms.

4.20 3.3.4.3 Sound characteristics of a Manifestation

⁸¹RDA 3.17. 01

Optionally, use a flag-type value indicating if the Manifestation includes recorded sound or not (i.e.: has sound: yes/no).

4.21 3.3.4.3.1 Sound systems

Describes the technical or proprietary system used to record the sound on a Manifestation/Item, for example, Dolby SR, Dolby Digital, etc. Select from a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.13 Item Sound System](#).

4.22 3.3.4.3.2 Sound Channel Configuration

If the Manifestation has sound, note here the track configuration (e.g., mono, stereo, etc.). Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms.

In case of presence of sound, optionally, if considered relevant, record the name of the physical principle of sound recording, for example, "Needle," "Optical," "Magnetic," etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.5 Manifestation/Item Sound Fixation Type](#).

If the Work/Variant associated with the Manifestation in hand had sound originally, but the Manifestation lacks sound, describe it as silent (or mute) and give a note to that effect.⁸²

If the Work/Variant associated with the Manifestation in hand was silent originally, but the Manifestation has sound added, describe it as sound and make a note to that effect.

The presence of colour(s), tone(s), etc. in a Manifestation.⁸³

Colour is also the specific colours, tones, etc. (including black and white) present in a moving image contained in a Manifestation.⁸⁴

It consists of a designation of the colour state and, optionally, of the description of the colour system.

Record the colour state of a Manifestation, for example, Black and white (tinted), Colour, Colour + Black & White, etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.11 Manifestation/Item Colour Type](#).

Optionally, if considered relevant, describe the system or process by which colour is fixed on the carrier or as part of the digital encoding, for example, Pathécolor, Technicolor, RGB, , etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.12 Manifestation/Item Colour Standard](#).

⁸⁵ The concept of extent as applied to Manifestations is the "ideal" logical, physical, or temporal (duration) units and not a description of a real physical object. Actual objects in the collection are described at the Item level.

The extent of a Manifestation must be recorded as a reference for the completeness of all the related Items, using appropriate authoritative secondary sources where feasible.

⁸²Based on AMIM2 5C3.

4.23 3.3.4.4 Colour characteristics of a Manifestation

⁸³RDA 7.17.3 Colour of Moving Image

⁸⁴RDA 7.17.3 Colour of Moving Image

4.24 3.3.5 Extent of a Manifestation

⁸⁵Partially based on EN 15907, 6.8 except for the physical components/units number, which is not provided for in the standard.

4.25 3.3.5.1 Logical extent of a Manifestation

Logical extent is the number of discrete logical units which make up the Manifestation, both for analogue (e.g. reels, cassettes, discs) and digital (cassettes, discs, files), considering that the digital Manifestations may be bound to a physical carrier (such as DVD) or exist without a defined carrier (such as online streaming media, podcasts, etc.).

For digital Manifestations, there can be two extents: one for the number of files, and one for the extent of the carrier (e.g., 2 LTO6 tapes).

Example:

A home video publication: DVD in 2 discs
A theatrical print: in 6 reels
A hard-disk stored film in 3 files

Record the number of the logical units of a Manifestation in Arabic numerals, and, if necessary, specify the type of unit, for example, reel, roll, disc, file, etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.6 Manifestation Unit Types](#).

If the number of the logical units of a Manifestation is uncertain, use a question mark following the unit count⁸⁶ or record the uncertain number preceded by “approximately.”⁸⁷

If the number of the logical units of a Manifestation is indeterminate, record the information using a value of “unknown.”

Alternatively, provide for a distinguishing “precision” field specifying if the unit number is exact, approximate or unknown.

4.26 3.3.5.2 Physical extent of a Manifestation

⁸⁸ Physical extent is the total “ideal” length or footage of the medium carrying the moving image Manifestation (using appropriate authoritative secondary sources where feasible such as filmographies, censorship visas, etc.).

The actual length is a characteristic of a singular Item since it can be different for multiple Items exemplifying the same Manifestation.

Record the total length in Arabic numerals, in metres or feet.

For digital Manifestations, record the total storage of all files that comprise the Manifestation. Use Arabic numerals followed by MB, GB, or TB as appropriate.

The Unit of Measurement (feet, metres, GB, etc.) can be provided in a separate field. This could be two separate fields side by side – one for numbers and one for size measurement.

If the length of a Manifestation is uncertain, use a question mark following the unit count or record the uncertain number preceded by “approximately.” In a note, give an explanation for the estimated footage or metre count, where known. Estimating the total storage size for a digital Manifestation can be particularly difficult, since storage can vary depending on technical characteristics of the file(s).

If the length of a Manifestation is unknown, record the information using a value of “unknown.”

Alternatively, provide for a distinguishing “precision” field specifying if the length is exact, approximate or unknown.

⁸⁶AMIM2, 5B5, p.9

⁸⁷RDA: 3.4.0.4

⁸⁸Based on FIAF 1991, 5.3.4.1, 87.

4.27 3.3.5.2.1 Physical extent of an Aggregate Manifestation

For Aggregate Manifestations record the length or footage of the whole, i.e. the total in feet or metres of all the units that constitute the Aggregate. In addition there is the option to qualify this with details of the physical extent of each individual unit in either a Notes field, or in multiple occurrences of the duration fields, depending on what systems used permit or an institution decides.

For more information about aggregates, see [Appendix E, Aggregates](#).

4.28 3.3.5.3 Duration of a Manifestation

⁸⁹ {#manual-2.3.5.3}

This is the total duration/running time under normal or specific playback conditions (e.g. a specific frame rate). It represents the concept of “ideal” duration/running time (i.e., the duration reported on the moving image Manifestation itself – i.e., on the container, on the accompanying material, on the wrapper of metadata in a digital file or reported by authoritative secondary sources such as filmographies, censorship visas, etc.). In cases where it is known that the time on the Manifestation is incorrect and all Items will inherit the same incorrect duration, record the accurate duration and make a note about the error/discrepancy found on the Manifestation.

The actual duration is usually considered a characteristic of a singular moving image Item, since it can differ among multiple Items exemplifying the same Manifestation.

Record, in Arabic numerals, the total duration/running time in minutes, normally rounded off to the nearest minute. Optionally, include minutes and seconds, or, for a higher level of precision and to enable calculations, use the format HH:MM:SS. This numeric format will help to calculate estimated digital storage in analogue-to-digital transfer projects.

If the duration/running time of a Manifestation is uncertain, use a question mark following the unit count or, if the system allows, use the qualifier “Duration Precision” and add the term “approximate.” (see [2.3.5.3.4 Duration Precision](#))

In a note, give an explanation for the estimated duration/running time, if such information applies. ⁹⁰

If the duration/running time of a Manifestation is unknown, record the information using a value of “unknown.”

4.29 3.3.5.3.1 Duration of an Aggregate Manifestation

For Aggregate Manifestations record the duration of the whole, i.e. the total running time of all the units that constitute the Aggregate. In addition there is the option to qualify this with details of the duration of each individual unit in either a Notes field, or in multiple occurrences of the duration fields, depending on what systems used permit or an institution decides.

Example:

DVD “The Audrey Hepburn Collection” contains 3 films, all with extra features. The running times for each of those 3 units are given on the container.
The total running time of these may be added as duration, with an additional clarifying note detailing the running times of the individual units.

For more information about Aggregates see [Appendix E, Aggregates](#).

4.30 3.3.5.3.2 Duration of a Manifestation associated with a Work/Variant of the silent era

When recording duration of Manifestations of a Work/Variant of the silent era, take into account that the rate of frames per second varied over the years and between Variants/Manifestations.

⁸⁹Based on FIAF 1991, 5.3.4.2.

⁹⁰Based on FIAF 1991, 5.3.4.2.

Also take into account the so-called “stretch frame” practice, adopted after the silent era, which “increases the number of frames printed on a film to enable films shot at silent speeds to be projected at sound speed and retain the original temporal characteristics.”⁹¹

In a note, indicate the frame rate on which the duration is based or if the Manifestation is the result of a “stretch frame” practice.⁹² (See also [3.1.5.12 Frame Rate](#))

When recording duration for Broadcast Manifestations there are two potential sets of data: a Slot Duration and an Actual Running Time. If the system allows, note the type of duration in the Duration Type element (see [2.3.5.3.5 Duration Type](#)).

Slot Duration relates to information from TV listings or publicity information for the programmed “slot” on the TV channel, whereas Actual Running Time relates to the exact running time of the entity when it was broadcast, excluding any inserted advertisements, etc. Thus, for example, an episode of the soap opera “Coronation Street” may have a Slot Duration of 30 minutes, but an Actual Running Time of 24 minutes.

Similarly, record the start and end time of the broadcast, ideally using 24-hour clock notation, e.g. 23:00 rather than 11:00pm. This may also involve two potential sets of data: a whole slot start and end time, or the actual more precise start and end time of the broadcast.

It is for an institution to choose whether to record both sets of data in each instance or limit to either just slot or actual broadcast/running times.

4.32 3.3.5.3.4 Duration Precision

In this qualifier, note whether the duration is exact, approximate, or estimated. Items can apply the additional “stock maximum.”

4.33 3.3.5.3.5 Duration Type

Where appropriate, add the type of duration being described. For example, broadcast materials could have “Slot Duration” and “Actual Duration.”

4.34 3.3.6 Notes for Manifestations

Notes for Manifestations are annotations providing additional information relating specifically to Manifestation attributes and relationships.⁹³ See [Appendix B, Cataloguer’s Notes](#).

A relationship associates an instance of Manifestation with another instance of an entity.

Relationships can be implemented in many ways, depending on the purpose, the modelling paradigm, or architectural constraints of the chosen platform. These guidelines are intended to be data structure neutral.⁹⁴ Therefore, these guidelines cannot prescribe exactly how to demonstrate relationships. Instead they recommend that certain relationships be established without instruction on how precisely those links be made manifest.

⁹¹Definition of “Stretch frame” taken from: <http://www.nfsa.gov.au/preservation/glossary/stretch-frame>.

⁹²Adapted from FIAF 5.3.4.2.

4.31 3.3.5.3.3 Duration of a Broadcast Manifestation associated with a Work/Variant

⁹³Based on RDA 2.20.1. Basic Instructions on Making Notes on Manifestations or Items

4.35 3.4 Relationships of a Manifestation

⁹⁴EN 15907 8.1 Relationships. General

4.36 3.4.1 Agent(s)

A Manifestation may have relationships with the following:

- Agent(s)
- Event(s)
- Other
- Item(s)
- Work
- Variant

An Agent for moving image Manifestations is defined as an entity that is involved in the exploitation (release, distribution, broadcasting), publishing, manufacturing or preservation of a Manifestation and who is considered to have major responsibility for, or be of major importance to, the Manifestation. Typical distinctions between agent types are Person, Corporate Body, Family and Person Group.⁹⁵

Work/Variant Agent(s) tend to be involved in the original creation of the Work/Variant so are not repeated in the Manifestation record. Only “new” Agents that contributed to the Manifestation as described above are included in the Manifestation record.

Agent(s) may also have relationships to an instance of a specific Event or of an “Other” relationship in connection with the Manifestation.

Because responsibility for moving image materials is most often complex and highly diverse, institutions - particularly those with special interests - should determine the types of roles they wish to include. These roles may vary from institution to institution according to the types of moving image material held. For example, an institution holding television material would probably consider, for Manifestations, the function of broadcaster more important than that of distributor. The opposite would be the case for institutions whose collections are composed of motion picture material. Provide access to Agents when they have made an important contribution to the particular Manifestation, even when the type of responsibility (credit function) is one that may not be considered major in other Manifestations.⁹⁶

In the case of aggregate Manifestations, if desirable and applicable, record multiple instances of Agent associated with the aggregated content.

4.37 3.4.1.1 Agent Activity

Describes the activity of the Agent(s) to make explicit the relationship(s) between the Agent(s) and the Manifestation.

Record one or more Agent activity terms, for example, “distributor,” “broadcaster,” “broadcast channel,” etc., to express the nature of the agent’s relationship to the Manifestation. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.8 Manifestation Agent Types](#).

Choose the single most specific term in each case, if possible. If no suggested terms apply, compose a term to describe the relationship between the creator and the Manifestation being catalogued. If the relationship is ambiguous, use a value to indicate this, for example, “unknown” to indicate a person performing in a capacity that is uncertain or not covered by typical terms.⁹⁷ Optionally, when the activity performed by an Agent is probable but not certain, provide the function name followed by a question mark.

Besides the principal Agent Activities suggested, institutions, particularly those with special interests, should create and apply in-house value lists of other specific Agent activities, which may vary from institution to institution.

Record in a note any additional details that cannot be expressed through controlled terms. (e.g. “appears only in final scene”, etc.). If a name is known to be fictitious, or requires clarification, make a note giving the actual name, etc.

⁹⁵ EN 15907, 5.1 Agent

⁹⁶ YCR, 1.3.2. Other creators, p. 42.

⁹⁷ List of relator terms are a combination of those found in YCR, 1.3.2. Other creators, pp. 42-43; and, OLAC TF, Part II, Core Attributes and Relationships, Commonly-Occurring Roles, pp. 16-1

For recording the attributes of Agents (e.g. first name, last name, nationality, etc.), refer to authoritative sources such as Functional requirements for authority data: a conceptual model or tools such as the [Library of Congress Name Authority File](#).⁹⁸ Optionally, if the Agent is credited under a name that is not identical with the preferred name from an authority file, record the name as used in the current instance of the related entity.⁹⁹

Give the Agent(s) and Agent Activity in the terms and language in which they appear, either in the sources of information or in the language of the institution, or both. If more than one Agent is associated with a particular role connected with a Manifestation or Event, where possible or desirable, record the names in the order indicated by the sequence, layout, or typography of the names on the source of information. Preserving the ordering of the credited persons should be determined by the requirements of individual institutions.¹⁰⁰

Example:

Broadcaster: CBS
Broadcast Channel: BBC1
Distributor: GUO Film Distributors
Publisher: Buena Vista International

4.38 3.4.2 Events

An Event characterises occurrences in the life cycle of a moving image Manifestation. Instances of any Event type can have Agent and “Other” relationships.

Record one or more Event type, for example, “decision,” “manufacture,” etc., to express the nature of the Event’s relationship to the Manifestation. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.4 Event Types](#).

4.39 3.4.3 “Other” relationships

Expresses relationships that are not covered by the Agent and Event relationships. Aggregation relationships are expressed at the Work/Variant level (see [Appendix E, Aggregates](#)).

Commonly-occurring relationships include:

- Manifestations that the moving image Manifestation forms part of (e.g. series/serials)

Example:

Le cryptogramme rouge (35mm print, m 984, m 48’ (18fps)
3° episode of the serial Les vampires (L. Feuillade, 1915).

- Manifestation(s) that the moving image Manifestation has a sequential relationship with (e.g. series/serials)
- Manifestation(s) that are promotional material(s) (i.e. trailers) for a particular Manifestation

Example:

Rashomon (Japan, 1950, A. Kurosawa) “has as promotional material”: Rashomon, Italian trailer (35mm), of the Italian theatrical release (1952).

- Non-moving image Works/Manifestation(s), about or relating to the moving image Manifestation (e.g. objects, articles, documents such as a review relating to a DVD home video)

⁹⁸Patton, Glenn E. 2009. Functional requirements for authority data: a conceptual model. München: K.G. Saur.

⁹⁹RDA 2.20.7.3

¹⁰⁰FIAF, 1.6.2, pp. 36-37.

publication, advertising materials referring to a specific theatrical distribution, related materials such as censorship visas, laboratory technical papers, etc.)

Examples:

Metro. Issue 157. June 2008. "DVD review: Blade Runner: The Final Cut", by Steven Aoun.

Der Dritte Mann (German film poster for the German-language Release Manifestation of the film The third man (United Kingdom, 1949, Carol Reed)

- Pre-release Manifestation(s) relating to a Release Manifestation

Examples:

Blow-up (UK-Italy, 1966, Michelangelo Antonioni)and Blow-up censorship cuts (35mm) of the Italian theatrical release (1967).

Othello, Orson Welles, USA- Italy-Morocco-France, 1952 and Otello, dailies and rushes, positive silent and some with sound, 35mm, containing shots included in only a very limited extent in the first theatrical release (their title proper in Italian is: Otello).

Record one or more "Other" relationship type to express the nature of the relationship to the Manifestation, choosing the most specific term possible from existing relator terms lists, for example, "commentary on," "review of," etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of values. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [Appendix D.17.2 Manifestation Other Relationship Types](#).

Or, compose a term to describe the relationship between the Manifestation being catalogued and the related Manifestation.

In a note, add any additional information concerning the relationship considered relevant.

Describe or demonstrate Manifestation-to-Manifestation relationships through linking to the Manifestation identifier of the related Manifestation, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of your data structure.

If the cataloguing system allows the procedure, attach a digital file that reproduces any associated "document."

4.40 3.4.4 Item(s)

Express the relationship between a moving image Manifestation and a moving image Item (e.g. Part/part of).

Here could be listed the unique Item identifiers associated to this Manifestation, noting their "part of " relationships to the Manifestation.

4.41 3.4.5 Work

Express the relationship between a moving image Manifestation and a moving image Work (e.g., Part/part of). Describe or demonstrate Manifestation-to-Work relationships through linking to the Manifestation identifier, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of your data structure.

4.42 3.4.6 Variant

Express the relationship between a moving image Manifestation and a moving image Variant (e.g., Part/part of). Describe or demonstrate Manifestation-to-Variant relationships through

linking to the Manifestation identifier, through the usage of relator terms, or according to the confines of your data structure.

4.43 3.5 Boundaries between Manifestations and Events

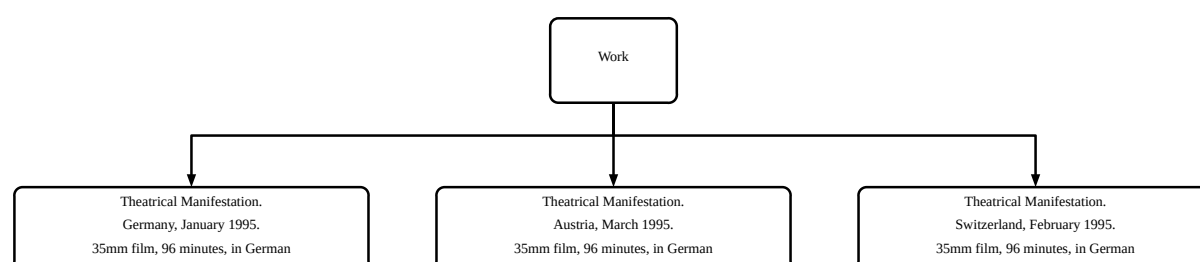
As mentioned previously, there is no rule within EN15907 as to the categories of Manifestation Type there can be, only that its values come from a controlled vocabulary list. The only one stipulated value that exists is that of a category of 'Unknown'.

Overlaps between use of Manifestations and Events, and Manifestation types and Event Publication types, have partly been due to some ambiguity within the EN15907 standard itself. But also, how the latter has been interpreted and evolved since it was conceived in order to deal with the nature and range of actual moving image material and technological developments, as well as the realities and practicalities for institutions using different cataloguing systems and databases, and user access needs.

Manifestation types	Event Publication types
Theatrical distribution	Theatrical distribution
Non-theatrical distribution	Non-theatrical distribution
Broadcast	Broadcast
Internet	Online transmission
Pre-release	Pre-release
Home viewing	Home video publication
Unknown	Unknown

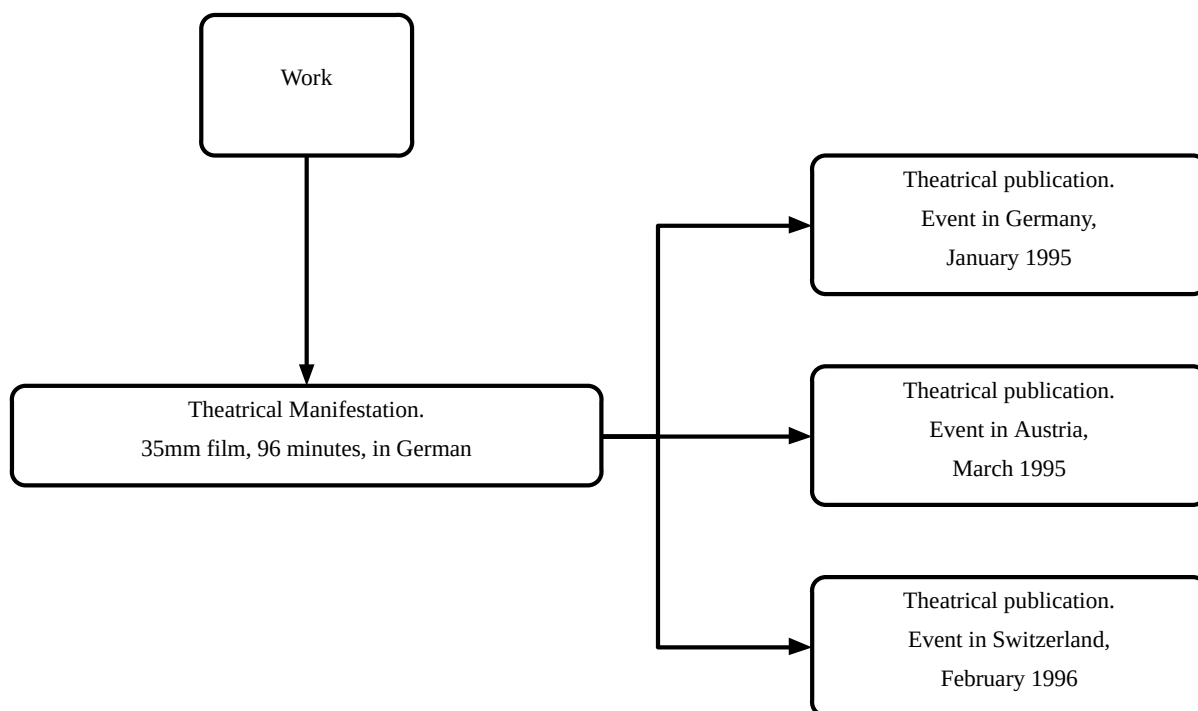
The boundaries between Manifestations and Events and structuring decisions will be dependent on the types of records, architecture, and concatenation and display capabilities of multiple linked data within an institution's database or other cataloguing system.

Some system databases may not have the ability or full functionality to have Events records, but do have Manifestations; in which case they may make use of a wider list of Manifestation Types and have fields relating to EN15907 Events data embedded within the Manifestation record itself. These systems will be more likely to make use of a structure of multiple Manifestations rather than one Manifestation with multiple publication Events. For example:



The EN15907 standard does not have date or release country as being core elements of a Manifestation, envisaging that information being in an associated Event. However, many systems do include those fields within their Manifestation records, as actual attributes of the Manifestation, as can be seen in some of the examples featured in Appendix I.[ADD LINK] In systems with no, or minimal, Events records capabilities it is the most logical alternative place to capture that important relevant data.

Other systems may have developed and utilise Events more in line with EN15907 to reflect data about different releases in various countries, e.g.



Structuring decisions around Manifestations and Events may also depend on the nature, size, use, and user needs of an institution's moving image collections.

In many cases, an institution is only going to create those Manifestations that pertain to acquired Item(s) in their collections, rather than add data about all international releases generally, so there will not usually be a need for a complexity of multiple linked Manifestations and/or Events records and data.

A broadcast as a Publication Event could suit where collections consist solely of cinematographic films. However, several institutions have collections consisting of both films and television programmes, where there needs to be a consistency and standardisation in structuring hierarchical metadata .

For a television programme, its broadcast is the actual primary manifestation of its Work not simply an event in the life-cycle of the Work. With the flexibility offered by Manifestation type it is possible and preferable to have a 'Broadcast' Manifestation type that can be used with television programme Works, thus maintaining the integrity of the EN15907 hierarchical structure.

This means that the one standard and structuring can be applied with mixed collections within the one moving image database system, rather than try to use EN15907 with films and another standard, such as PBCore, with television programmes.

Institutions may also not only collect and acquire items, but develop their own VOD (Video on Demand) channels, e.g. BFIplayer which provides a mixture of Free, Subscription and Transactional VOD, using digital items to stream the content. Thus, having an Internet Manifestation type means that both acquired or produced VOD materials can be captured within an EN15907 structure. The actual digital Items held and representing records for the files used in streaming can then be linked to these Manifestations.

There is also the question of a "pure EN15907 structure" approach meaning disparate pieces of relevant and related data sitting in the Manifestation and the Event and how that may impact user access, how to prevent a tangle of complex structuring with a variety of materials in a collection for the same Work, and realistic resourcing and capabilities of database systems used by Archives and institutions. This manual recognises both the purist and pragmatic approaches.

For those cataloguing in non-relational databases, paper or card catalogues, or Excel, then many of the elements that EN15907 sees as being linked "related" records, including Events, will always be an attribute of the main 1-level hierarchy moving image record.

As with the ability to utilise EN15907 within a 4, 3, 2 or 1-level hierarchy, the same fundamental principle applies with use and structure of Events with Works, Variants, Manifestations or Items; namely, that it does not matter what data systems or structures an institution uses – whether index card or complex computer systems – as long as their records capture the relevant data concerned.

With a fundamental aim of EN15907 being interoperability, then use of the FIAF list of Manifestation Types is key to the flexibility and use of the data architecture reflecting the standard and makes this a lot more achievable; especially in systems where Events structures are minimal or do not exist. Because there is an overlap in Manifestation and Event type terms it could make potential mapping and interoperability achievable.

5 4. Moving Image Items

4.1 Elements of a moving image Item

4.1.1 Identifier

4.1.2 Title

4.1.3 Holding institution

4.1.4 Item Element type

4.1.5 Item Specifics/Extent (e.g. physical/Digital description)

4.1.6 Access conditions

4.1.7 Notes for Items

4.2 Boundaries between Items

4.3 Relationships of an Item

4.3.1 Agent(s)

4.3.2 Events

4.3.3 Other Relationships

4.3.4 Manifestation

5.1 4.0 Definition

A moving image Item is the physical or digital product of a Manifestation of a Work or Variant, i.e. the actual copy of a Work or Variant. Whereas the Manifestation record describes the “ideal” of a particular format or publication, the Item record represents the actual holding in a repository’s collection.

An Item may consist of one or more components, i.e. the whole Item may consist of 1 reel or 5 reels, 2 VHS tapes or 1 DVD. An Item record may contain fields or scope for separate barcodes and condition information for each component of the item (each reel for example) if required.

The Item may be whole or incomplete or a fragment. In the case of purely digital media, an Item is defined as the availability of the computer file, irrespective of the number of backup copies that may exist.¹⁰¹

5.2 4.1 Elements of a moving image Item

A majority of the physical and digital description elements of moving image Items are intended to be inherited from the Manifestations, as they serve as the exemplars of Manifestations. In some databases, selection of a physical carrier type initiates provision of element fields relevant to that type at a Manifestation level, or an Item level, or both (e.g. in a 2 Level hierarchy. See “Shallow hierarchy model: 2 levels” in [0.2.1 Elements of description across Works, Variants, Manifestations, and Items](#)).

Ideally the information need only be recorded once irrespective of where in the data structure an institution must place it. Therefore guidelines for the treatment of physical/digital description elements are explained fully in the Manifestation chapter.

This chapter contains Item-specific physical/digital description elements beginning at Section 3.1.5 (see [3.1.5 Item Specifics/Extent \(e.g. physical/Digital description\)](#)). For example, properties such as Extent and Format at the Manifestation level represent the “ideal,” and item-specific information will capture where it differs from this ideal. Only elements that are considered Item-specific have guidelines for the recording of data. Physical/digital description elements that are considered Manifestation-specific, but which may be repeated at the Item level, contain hyperlinks to the relevant sections in the Manifestation chapter.

5.3 4.1.1 Identifier

Create an unambiguous numerical or alphanumerical reference to the moving image Item, such as a call number, barcode, shelf mark or similar, to uniquely identify the copy.¹⁰² This may be in addition to separate Acquisition and Accession number(s) or identifier(s).

For digital files, the filename is not an identifier since filenames can change. Instead, the filename is tracked as part of the technical metadata associated with a digital item.

As with Work and Manifestation Identifiers, an Item can have more than one Identifier. For example, a film Item may have a barcode for the can and a shelf number for its location. Note the type of Identifier using Identifier Type.

If an institution’s system allows, a “Type” can be applied with an Identifier to define the source of the Identifier. Examples: Barcode, Shelf mark, Accession number.

5.5 4.1.2 Title

Record at least one title, identifying phrase, or name for the moving image Item Title.

¹⁰¹Digital medium definition taken from CEN’s “Film Identification – enhancing interoperability of metadata. Element sets and structures. FprEN 15907:2010 (E)

¹⁰²EN 15907, “Inventory number,” p. 12

5.4 4.1.1.1 Identifier Type

If multiple titles are recorded, where allowable, associate a “Title Type” to a title for differentiation between the various types of titles (see [A.2 Title Types](#)).

In most cases the title of an Item will be the same as that of the Manifestation to which it pertains.

The title of an Item can sometimes differ, either slightly or wholly from the title of the Manifestation, and/or Work/Variant to which it is linked. In particular, this may be the case where an incomplete physical product of the Manifestation has been acquired. For example, if a film in the collection is missing the first reel where opening title credits usually appear, the Item will not have a title to be transcribed.

For creating titles for untitled or unidentified entities see [A.2.5 Supplied/Devised Titles](#)

For the treatment of Aggregates (e.g. compilations of whole Manifestations) as applied to Items, see Appendix [E.4 Titling of Aggregates] for titling of Aggregates.

For guidance on wording, order, spelling, punctuation, accentuation and capitalisation, see [Chapter 0. Preliminary Notes](#).

For sources of information for the Title, see [Section 0.3 Sources of Information](#).

5.6 4.1.2.1 Title Type

Items can have more than just the title transcribed from the opening credits. There can be title information written on leader, cans, and video containers. Sometimes this information is different to what is in the credits; sometimes it is the only source of information to help identify an Item’s content.

Note the source of title information. For Items where the only title information is found on a can or leader, use an Acquisition Title Type(s) (see [A.2.4.1 Alternative title types](#)) or descriptive words such as “Title on can” or “Title on leader.”

5.7 4.1.3 Holding institution

¹⁰³ {#manual-3.1.3}

Record the name of the institution possessing the moving image Item or authorised to make it available.

Optionally, if available, record a suitable repository identifier or a registered namespace identifier for the institution.

¹⁰⁴ {#manual-3.1.4}

Record the nature or function of the moving image Item, describing its place in the photochemical or digital production or duplication process, for example, “original negative,” “duplicate negative,” etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.8 Item Element Type](#).

All moving image Item descriptions should contain details of the physical/digital characteristics of the Items, their location, treatment and condition.

Institutions with archival moving images need to describe their holdings accurately for preservation, copying and reconstruction purposes. Often there will be physically separate Items, for example image, track, music, different colour bases, etc., which are all essential parts of a single

¹⁰³Based on EN 15907, Holding institution

5.8 4.1.4 Item Element type

¹⁰⁴Based on EN 15907, Instantiation type

5.9 4.1.5 Item Specifics/Extent (e.g. physical/Digital description)

moving image.¹⁰⁵ Descriptive terminology covering all areas of physical description and attributes should be established in controlled lists of terms, to be applied in the relevant categories. The range of these and what they are can be established in-house or utilising an established list, for example, the [FIAF Glossary of Technical Terms](#).

Each Item should have its own description, whether the physical/digital characteristics between Items differ in one way or another, for example, in length, gauge, base, sound, etc., or, the Items acquired are duplicate identical copies.

Institutions may record as much technical information as they wish or need, but the Physical and Digital Description elements of an Item should ideally consist of the elements listed in the sub-sections below where discernible.

Further data relating to the condition, preservation, location, and, acquisition, accessioning, and source of the Item are also recommended elements for the Item (see [3.1.6 Access conditions](#)).

These may be either added to the Item description itself or, where this is not possible, related to other separate files or databases, via physical link or text indication.

5.10 4.1.5.1 Carrier Type

Carrier type is the medium on or the encoding format in which the Item is fixed.

Its description consists of a general carrier type, which describes the basic properties of the Item's physical format, for example, film, video tape, digital file, etc., and a specific carrier type, which corresponds to the gauge, in case of films and tapes, and for digital files, to the physical carrier on which the file is stored.

5.11 4.1.5.1.1 General Carrier Type

The broad media type of the Item (e.g., film, video, audio, optical, digital file). Recording this high-level information will enable simple searching for only film, video, digital, etc. elements rather than searching by all possible formats and carriers.

Record only if this information is not captured at the Manifestation level or if required at the Item level by the system in use.

A suggested list can be found in [D.7.1 Manifestation/Item General Carrier Type](#).

For reasons of clarity and to avoid redundancy, optionally, institutions can decide to skip the general carrier type description for film and video, since it is already implicit in the specific carrier type.

5.12 4.1.5.1.2 Specific Carrier Type

Record the specific carrier type, by indicating

1. For film and video: the width of the film stock or of the magnetic tape on which the Item is fixed;
2. For digital files: The physical carrier storing the digital file.

For digital files, it is most important for users to immediately identify the file container or wrapper (MXF, MOV, DPX, etc.) rather than the physical media on which it is stored. Physical media storing a file can change, but that does not necessarily mean that the file format has changed. It is the digital file format that is the important distinguishing factor. Information on the specific codecs and resolution are captured in other Item elements.

For optical media, only add commercially produced media here. If the optical media is "writable" and is being used to store a digital file, put the digital file format in the general carrier type, and the optical storage media in specific media type.

¹⁰⁵ See The FIAF Cataloguing Rules for Film Archives (1991). 5. Physical Description. Introduction

Record the specific carrier type, selecting from a suitable controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.2 Manifestation/Item Specific Carrier Type](#).

5.13 4.1.5.2 Item Status

Description of the preservation or access status of the Item, for example Master, Viewing, etc. Select term from a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.3 Item Preservation/Access status](#).

5.14 4.1.5.3 Sound

Technical specifications relating to the fixation of sound in a moving image Manifestation/Item (see [2.3.4.3 Sound characteristics of a moving image Manifestation](#)). This element is for high-level description of sound on the item; i.e., noting whether it has sound, is silent, etc.

Indicate the presence or absence of sound in the Manifestation/Item, i.e. "sound," "silent," "mute", "combined" or "mixed" etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.4 Manifestation/Item Sound Type](#).

Record only if this information is not captured at the Manifestation level or if required at the Item level by the system in use.

5.15 4.1.5.4 Sound Channel Configuration

If the Item has sound, note here the track configuration (e.g., mono, stereo, etc.) Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms.

5.16 4.1.5.5 Sound System

See also [2.3.4.3 Sound characteristics of a Manifestation](#)

Describes the technical or proprietary system used to record the sound on a Manifestation/Item, for example, Dolby SR, Dolby Digital, etc. Select from a controlled list. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.13 Item Sound System](#).

5.17 4.1.5.6 Colour

For full instructions, see [2.3.4.4 Colour characteristics of a Manifestation](#).

The presence of colour(s), tone(s), etc. in an Item.¹⁰⁶

Record only if this information is not captured at the Manifestation level or if required at the Item level by the system in use.

For full instructions see [2.3.5.1 Logical extent of a Manifestation](#)

The number of discrete logical units that make up the moving image Item. Item unit number(s) may differ from that of the associated Manifestation. The unit number in Manifestation relates to the ideal, whereas the Item unit number refers to the actual units held by the institution, e.g. an institution may have only acquired 3 reels of a 4-reel film.

5.19 4.1.5.8 Extent

The actual physical/digital extent is a characteristic of a singular Item, since it can be different for multiple Items exemplifying the same moving image Manifestation.

¹⁰⁶RDA 7.17.3 Colour of Moving Image

5.18 4.1.5.7 Unit number

For film, record footage for the film reel in feet or metres. This footage represents actual length, rather than the “ideal” length, which is recorded for Manifestations (see [2.3.5.2 Physical extent of a Manifestation](#)). If your system allows, provide the Unit of Measurement – feet or metres – in another element. Having separate numeric fields can facilitate calculations in determining the amount of footage that will be preserved.

For digital files, enter the numerical measurement indicating the size of the digital asset’s file(s), in KB, MB, GB, or TB.

As above, the Unit of Measurement (feet, metres, GB, etc.) may be provided in a separate field. This could be two separate fields side by side – one for numbers and one for size measurement. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.9 Item File Size – Digital](#).

If the length of an Item is uncertain, use a question mark following the unit count or record the uncertain number preceded by “approximately.” In a note, give an explanation for the estimated footage or metre count, where known.

If the length of an Item is indeterminate, record the information using a value of “unknown.”

Alternatively, provide for a distinguishing “precision” field specifying if the length is exact, approximate or unknown.

5.20 4.1.5.9 Projection characteristics

For full instructions, see [2.3.4.2 Projection characteristics of a Manifestation](#)

The projection characteristics of a Manifestation/Item include aspect ratio and aperture or image format.

Record only if this information is not captured at the Manifestation level or if required at the Item level by the system in use.

5.21 4.1.5.10 Broadcast standard - Video

The broadcast standard for a video or DVD/BluRay: NTSC, PAL, SECAM.

5.22 4.1.5.11 Duration

Duration in minutes of the moving image(s) contained in the Item, not the total duration of the Manifestation. Optionally, include minutes and seconds, or, for a higher level of precision and to enable calculations, use the format HH:MM:SS. This numeric format will help to calculate estimated digital storage in analogue-to-digital transfer projects.

This duration represents actual temporal extent, rather than the “ideal” temporal extent, which is recorded for Manifestations (see [2.3.5.3 Duration of a Manifestation](#)). Actual duration is a characteristic of a singular Item, since it can differ among multiple Items exemplifying the same Manifestation.

If the duration/running time of an Item is uncertain, use a question mark following the unit count or record the uncertain number preceded by “approximately.” If necessary, in a note, give an explanation for the estimated duration/running time, where known.

If the duration/running time of an Item is indeterminate, record the information using a value of “unknown.”

Alternatively, provide for a distinguishing “precision” field specifying if the duration/ running time is exact, approximate or unknown. If the Item is a video or audio tape where the tape stock maximum duration is identified (e.g., Fuji M321-SP 30M is a Betacam SP tape of 30 minutes duration), that maximum duration can be noted in the “precision” field as “stock maximum.” This information can be helpful since it implies the Item cannot be longer than the maximum duration of the stock.

5.23 4.1.5.11.1 Duration Precision

In this qualifier, note whether the duration is exact, approximate, estimated, or stock maximum.

5.24 4.1.5.12 Frame Rate

Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.18 Item Frame Rate/Transfer Speed](#).

Frame rate is the native frame rate for the Item. Information related to the frame rate used during a digitisation process is added to Transfer Speed (see [3.1.5.23 Transfer Speed](#)).

Frame Rate and Transfer Speed can sometimes be the same thing, and at other times different, depending on whether it is an Item that is being scanned into a digital file or an Item that is a digital file to start with. For example, a silent film that was shot at a 16 fps frame rate could be transferred at 23.98 fps. In this case, the resulting digital file would have a frame rate of 23.98, even though the original film is 16 fps.

Precision can be added to this element by adding a “Type” qualifier to note if the frame rate is original, or the transfer rate.

Note that in digital cinema, a film can have Variable frame rates.

5.25 4.1.5.13 Base

The physical material or video format on which the Item is captured, for example, describing the flexible transparent material that supports a film items’ emulsion or a magnetic track, (e.g., acetate, nitrate, CTA, etc.). Select from controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.7 Item Base – Film or Video](#).

5.26 4.1.5.14 Stock

Describes the specific stock/brand on which the Item is captured, for example, Eastman Kodak, Fuji, 3M, etc. This element should be used for all media: film, video, audio, optical, digital tape, external hard drives. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.16 Item Stock](#).

5.27 4.1.5.15 Stock batch

The stock batch number of the media the Item is captured on. This can be a video, audio, optical media, or digital tape stock. Identifying the batch number can assist in identifying problems related to specific manufactured batches.

5.28 4.1.5.16 Video Codec

The video compression standard used in the digital video Item, for example, D10, MP4, etc.

Video and digital cinema formats contained in wrappers have separate audio files contained in the format with the video file. For example, DCPs (contained in MXF files) are comprised of a JPEG2000 video file and a WAV audio file (along with textual information in an XML file), The audio codec is described separately.

Select from controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.10 Item Code type – Digital](#). Other lists include:

PBCore essenceTrackEncoding vocabulary: http://metadataregistry.org/concept/list/vocabulary_id/156.html

EBUCore Video Compression Code: https://www.ebu.ch/metadata/cs/web/ebu_VideoCompressionCodeCS_p.xr

5.29 4.1.5.17 Audio Codec

The audio compression standard used in the audio file, whether it is contained in a wrapper with a video file or as a standalone audio file.

Select from controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.10 Item Codec type](#). Other lists include:

PBCore essenceTrackEncoding vocabulary: http://metadataregistry.org/concept/list/vocabulary_id/156.html

EBUCore Video Compression Code: https://www.ebu.ch/metadata/cs/web/ebu_VideoCompressionCodeCS_p.xr

5.30 4.1.5.18 Resolution

Note whether the Item's resolution is Standard Definition, High Definition, etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.19 Item Resolution](#).

5.31 4.1.5.19 Line standard – Video

Describes the number of scan lines which make up the image and indicates the resolution, for example, 405, 525, 1080. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.21 Item Line Standard – Video](#).

5.32 4.1.5.20 Bit Depth

Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.17 Item Bit Depth – Digital](#).

Note that bit depth can be used in describing both video and audio files.

5.33 4.1.5.21 Source Device

Record the source playback device used in transfer projects. This can be a video deck, film printer, or hardware.

Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.20 Item Source Device – Digital](#).

5.34 4.1.5.22 Source Software

Record the source software used in playing a digital file.

5.35 4.1.5.23 Transfer Speed

Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.7.18 Item Frame Rate/Transfer Speed – Digital](#).

If the Transfer Speed is the same as the Frame Rate ([3.1.5.12 Frame Rate](#)), these values should be the same. However, silent films might be transferred at a higher speed than the original frame rate. For example, a silent film that was shot at a 16fps frame rate could be transferred at 23.98 fps. It is important to note the transfer speed so an institution can identify how the transferred Item compares to the source Item. If the transfer speed is faster than the source frame rate, the target Item could have a shorter duration than the source Item.

5.36 4.1.6 Access conditions

Record any information on how and to whom the moving image Item can be made available, including details of the condition of the Item and of its treatment, preservation or restoration Events. This creates a condition and preservation history for the Item, and is also important for assessing conservation conditions and establishing and prioritising collections care and preservation activities.

5.37 4.1.6.1 Item condition

Observations about conditions will typically happen in the course of an Event such as inspection of an Item. These observations should aim to be as clear and concise as possible, avoiding abbreviations and initials, and as far as possible using controlled vocabulary. For example, establish whether to use “scratched”, “scratches” or “scratch marks” and be as consistent as possible. This enables better searching and accessibility of data.

Record these actions as an Event (see [3.3.2 Events](#)), with the person or entity performing the action as an Agent (see [3.3.1 Agent\(s\)](#)).

Ideally, elements covering information and details regarding the condition of an acquired Item would include those listed below.

This could be recorded using single or multiple specific headed fields (i.e., covering Base, Emulsion, Image, Perforations, etc.), and then sub-sections of the latter, to incorporate data ranging from graded scales designations (either numerical or alphabetical, for example 1-5, A-G, Perfect – Very Poor) with clear definitions of what each designation means; condition terms selected from a controlled list; free text additional qualification or clarification in observations or comments sections; identification of technical assessor; and, dates.

Record the condition of the Item including its base and/or emulsion and/or perforations, where applicable. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms, for example, “brittle”, “buckled”, “tears,” etc. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.16 Manifestation/Item Condition, Preservation and Restoration](#).

Capture the date on which the condition of the Item was recorded (using ISO standard¹⁰⁷). The identification of the individual who carried out the technical assessment and has recorded the condition should also be given. Any names should be given in full, rather than initials or abbreviations. As stated above, people or companies performing inspections are Agents.

Note any indication that the Item is in need of servicing prior to being accessed for use.

Item descriptions should indicate a storage location number in order to provide access and retrieval. Movements and changes of location should also be logged in order to ascertain the precise location of an Item at any given time. If possible, use the Item Identifier and Identifier Type fields to note an Item’s location (see [3.1.1 Identifier](#)).

This could be a single simple field, or could include multiple fields to reflect various electronic package or barcode numbers that may be attached to each individual can or container, shelf, or whatever is applicable to an individual institution.

5.39 4.1.7 Notes for Items

Notes for Items are an annotation providing additional information relating specifically to Item attributes and relationships.¹⁰⁸ See [Appendix B, Cataloguer’s Notes](#).

The boundaries between moving image Items is determined primarily by the boundaries between Manifestations (see [2.1 Boundaries between Manifestations](#)). There may be multiple Items associated to a Manifestation that are, for all intents and purposes, exact copies, but which may have small differences that do not necessitate representation as a Manifestation. For example, an institution may have two DVD-R copies of the same Manifestation, with cosmetic differences in their labels.

¹⁰⁷ISO 8601

5.38 4.1.6.2 Item location

¹⁰⁸Based on RDA 2.20.1.Basic Instructions on Making Notes on Manifestations or Items

5.40 4.2 Boundaries between Items

5.41 4.3 Relationships of an Item

A relationship associates an instance of an Item with another instance of an entity.

Relationships can be implemented in many ways, depending on the purpose, the modelling paradigm, or architectural constraints of the chosen platform. These guidelines are intended to be data structure neutral.¹⁰⁹ Therefore, these guidelines cannot prescribe exactly how to demonstrate relationships. Instead they recommend that certain relationships be established without instruction on how precisely those links be made manifest.

An Item may have relationships with the following:

- Agent(s)
- Event(s)
- Other
- Manifestation

5.42 4.3.1 Agent(s)

An Agent for moving image Items is defined as an entity that is involved in the acquisition, movement (for loans, inspection, storage, etc.), or preservation of a moving image Item and who is considered to have major responsibility for, or be of major importance to, the moving image Item. Typical distinctions between Agent types are Person, Corporate Body, Family and Person Group.¹¹⁰

Agent(s) may also have relationships to an instance of a specific Event or of an "Other" relationship in connection with the Item.

Because responsibility for moving image materials is most often complex and highly diverse, institutions - particularly those with special interests - should determine the types of functions they wish to include in this area. These functions may vary from institution to institution according to the types of moving image material held.

Describes the activity of the Agent to make explicit the relationship(s) between the Agent and the Item.

Record one or more Agent activity terms, for example, "preservationist," "curator," "acquisition source", etc., to express the nature of the Agent's relationship to the Item. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms.

Choose the single most specific term, if possible. If no suggested terms apply, compose a term to describe the relationship between the Agent and the Item. If the relationship is ambiguous, use a value to indicate this, for example, "unknown." Optionally, when the role performed by an Agent is probable but not certain, provide the function name followed by a question mark, or by a qualifying note.

Besides the principal Agent Activities suggested, institutions, particularly those with special interests, should create and apply in-house value lists of other specific Agent activities, which may vary from institution to institution.

Record in a note any additional details that cannot be expressed through controlled terms. If a name is known to be fictitious, or requires clarification, make a note giving the actual name, etc.

For recording the attributes of Agents (e.g. first name, last name, nationality, etc.), refer to authoritative sources such as Functional requirements for authority data: a conceptual model or tools such as the Library of Congress Name Authority File.¹¹¹ Optionally, if the Agent is credited under a name that is not identical with the preferred name from an authority file, record the name as used in the current instance of the related entity.¹¹²

¹⁰⁹EN 15907 8.1 Relationships. General

¹¹⁰EN 15907, 5.1 Agent

5.43 4.3.1.1 Agent Activity

¹¹¹Patton, Glenn E. 2009. Functional requirements for authority data: a conceptual model. München: K.G. Saur.

¹¹²RDA 2.20.7.3

Provide access to the Agent(s) and Agent Activity in the terms and language in which they appear, either in the sources of information or in the language of the institution, or both. If more than one Agent is associated with a particular role connected with an Item or Event, where possible or desirable, record the names in the order indicated by the sequence, layout, or typography of the names on the source of information. Preserving the ordering of the credited persons should be determined by the requirements of individual institutions.¹¹³

An Event characterises occurrences in the life cycle of a moving image Item. Instances of any Event type can have Agent and “Other” relationships.

Record one or more Event types, for example, “preservation,” “inspection,” “acquisition”, etc., to express the nature of the Event’s relationship to the Item. Selection should be made from a controlled list of terms. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.4 Event Types](#).

5.45 4.3.3 Other Relationships

Express relationships that are not covered by the Agent and Event relationships. These may include compilations of convenience, i.e. where an institution has transferred copies of two or more films onto one reel/tape/DVD etc. for convenient storage.¹¹⁴

- Item(s) associated with the moving image Item

It is possible for a moving image Item to have a horizontal relationship with another Item as a related object. Such associative relationships are more prevalent and varied at the Work level, but there are instances where Items need to be related, for example, where an institution has separate Items for Yellow, Cyan and Magenta Separation Negatives, each of which have to be combined in Technicolor Three Colour Strip Process to make a new colour print. Or, hold separate sound and image Items that would both be needed to make a new print. Similarly, in the case of restorations where separate Items or elements have been used to create a new restored Item.

Examples:

The Wizard of Oz (United States of America, 1939, Victor Fleming)
Yellow Separation Negative, Cyan Separation Negative, Magenta Separation Negative

Local hero (United Kingdom, 1983, Bill Forsyth)
DPX sequence, WAV audio file

- An Item that contains other Items (e.g. two or more separate Items are held on the same reel/tape/DVD etc. for convenient storage).

Examples:

Selezione Fregoli 2002
Compilation of 16 short Fregoli films, spliced together for projection convenience.

Laughing gas (United States of America, 1914, Charlie Chaplin)
Those love pangs (United States of America, 1914, Charlie Chaplin)
(two Charlie Chaplin short comedies spliced together on one reel - for storage convenience).

¹¹³FIAF, 1.6.2, pp. 36-37.

5.44 4.3.2 Events

¹¹⁴See Appendix [E.2 Identifying Aggregates](#)

- Item that is the source of a moving image Item (e.g. In-house copying of an Item to create a new Item for preservation or access)

Example:

35mm CTA Duplicating Positive copy of Carnival (c.1927) made from a 35mm Nitrate Negative copy of Carnival (c.1927)

- Non-moving image Works/Items (e.g. Objects, documents, etc. relating to a specific Item)

Example:

Shots of 1932 (United Kingdom, 1932) (home movie) 9.5mm Safety film Item related to paper donor agreement

Record one or more “Other” relationship type terms to express the nature of the relationship to the Item, choosing the most specific term possible from existing relator terms lists, for example, “accompanied by,” “contained in,” etc. Selection should be made from a controlled list of values. A suggested list, which is open and not exhaustive, can be found in [D.17.3 Item Other Relationship Types](#).

In a note, add any additional information concerning the relationship considered relevant.

If the cataloguing system allows, attach a digital file that reproduces any associated “document”.

5.46 4.3.4 Manifestation

Express the relationship between a moving image Manifestation and a moving image Item (e.g. Part/part of).